

Admission letter and contract

Dear Jean Philippe Placide Bakala Bounou,

Congratulations! GEM Alpine Business School (GEM) is pleased to inform you that your candidacy has been reviewed by the Admissions Board and we would like to offer you a place on the Global Doctorate of Business Administration (DBA) programme for the intake starting on 1st November 2026.

To help us manage the admissions and secure your place on the programme, we ask you to confirm your decision to join the programme by signing this Higher Education Training Contract and paying your first instalment by the date indicated on your payment schedule.

Once the payment has been received, an access code to GEM online resources will be sent to you.

We look forward to welcoming you onto the programme and seeing you in Grenoble!

Yours sincerely,



Dr Caroline GAUTHIER
Director of the Doctoral School

**Higher Education Training Contract
Academic Years 2026/2029**

Between

Bakala Bounbou Jean Philippe Placide
Ouakam terminus P7
Ouakam terminus P7
12000 Dakar
Senegal

Hereinafter referred to as: the "Student"

On the one hand,

EESC GRENOBLE ECOLE DE MANAGEMENT
12 rue Pierre Sémard
38000 GRENOBLE - FRANCE
Siret: 817 389 141 00018

Hereinafter referred to as: "GEM"

Represented by

Fouziya BOUZERDA

Duly authorised to sign this contract,

On the other hand,

A Higher Education Training Contract, hereinafter referred to as the "Training Contract", is signed:

Siège social
12 rue Pierre Sémard
38000 Grenoble - France
Tel : +33 4 76 70 60 60 Fax : +33
4 76 70 60 99
E mail : info@grenoble-em.com
www.grenoble-em.com



ARTICLE 1: Purpose of the contract

In application of this contract, GEM undertakes to organise the training programme entitled "Doctorate in Business Administration", hereinafter referred to as the "DBA Programme".

ARTICLE 2: Duration of the contract

This contract is entered into from the date of its electronic signature until 31st October 2029.

Its term may be extended by way of an amendment in the event of:

- The Student taking an abeyance, by decision of the Doctoral School Review Committee;
- The Student registering for an additional year to complete their thesis, by decision of the Doctoral School Review Committee;

Early termination may be at the initiative of GEM or the Student. If the early termination is at the Student's initiative then they must be in good administrative standing before the contract can be terminated.

If the Student does not finish the training programme within the initially proposed three year period, the Doctoral School Review Committee may authorise an extension to the training period, this will be formalised in an amendment to the Training Contract. The procedure is described in the DBA student handbook in Appendix 2

ARTICLE 3: Training conditions

The training seminars and webinars shown in Appendix 1 can take place at GEM premises, and/or at a partner's premises and/or in a company, and/or by distance learning.

In signing this contract, the Student undertakes to fulfill the material and technical conditions in order to participate in classes, examinations and continuous assessments in person and remotely.

The DBA Programme will be organised under the conditions defined by the DBA student handbook in Appendix 2.

The Student must attend all seminars and webinars before defending their thesis.

ARTICLE 4: Right of withdrawal

In accordance with Article L221-18 of the French Consumer Code, the Student is informed that they have 14 days from the signing of the training contract to withdraw.

No amount may be invoiced in the event of withdrawal within this period.

To withdraw, the Student must use the withdrawal form provided in Appendix 3 of this contract and send it by email with delivery and read receipt to the Programme Coordinator.

ARTICLE 5: Financial terms and conditions

The cost of the DBA Programme is 60 000€ (sixty thousand euros) for the 3 years of training, which the Student undertakes to pay to Grenoble Ecole de Management by signing this contract.

Any training started is due in its entirety except in the event of "Force Majeure" or legitimate and serious reasons duly justified to the Programme Coordinator by email with delivery and read receipt within 24 hours of the start of the opening seminar.

In the event of failure to pay the sums due within the agreed deadlines, GEM may automatically terminate this contract 30 days after sending a formal notice by email with delivery and read receipt which has remained unanswered.

5.1 Cost of the DBA Programme

The cost of the 3-year programme is as follows:

Year 1	20 000 euros
Year 2	20 000 euros
Year 3	20 000 euros
Total	60 000 euros

In the event of a student registering for an additional year, confirmed by decision of the Doctoral School Review Committee, the Student will be invoiced for this additional year at 12 000€ (twelve thousand euros). The fees will be invoiced on a semester basis.

The additional year will be formalized in an amendment to this Training Contract.

The fee does not include costs of extra services or services obtained by the Student. For example, transport, accommodation, insurance, and meals are not provided in The DBA Programme.

5.2 Terms of payment

The Student commits to pay their tuition fees by the dates as follows:

Academic Year	Payment date and amount	
Year 1	Within 15 days following receipt of this admission letter and Training Contract Amount due: 10 000 €	1 st December 2026 Amount due: 10 000 €
Year 2	1 st December 2027 Amount due: 20 000 €	
Year 3	1 st December 2028 Amount due: 20 000 €	
Additional year 1	1 st December 2029 Amount due: 6 000 €	31 st May 2030 Amount due: 6 000 €
Additional year 2	1 st December 2030 Amount due: 6 000 €	31 st May 2031 Amount due: 6 000 €

The Student is responsible for all bank transfer charges and commissions incurred in the transaction.

All payments should to be made to Grenoble Ecole de Management in euros. The school will issue its own invoice to be paid directly to the school and to no other intermediary.

Payment may be made by bank transfer to

BNP Paribas Arc Alpin Entreprise, 60 rue Lavoisier, ZIRST de Montbonnot, 38330 MONTBONNOT.
Bank Code 30004 / Branch Code 00617 / Account n° 00023171726 / Key 80
IBAN : FR76 3000 4006 1700 0231 7172 680 - Swift : BNPAFRPPXXX

Or by Flywire

Euros : <https://grenoble-dba.flywire.com>

In case of late payment, financial penalties in an amount equal to three times the legal interest rate in force shall be due as well as a fixed sum of 40 euros as compensation for the recovery costs.

ARTICLE 6: Insurance

The DBA Programme organised by GEM does not include insurance. The Student is responsible for ensuring that adequate insurance cover is taken.

GEM has no liability for any damage occurring outside its premises, facilities or resulting from the Students' acts.

ARTICLE 7: Personal data

For the proper fulfilment of this contract, the Student consents to GEM processing personal data concerning them, in accordance with the French Data Protection Act No. 78/19 of January 6, 1978, as amended, and the General Data Protection Regulation (EU) No. 2016/679 of April 26, 2016 (hereinafter "Applicable Regulations on the Protection of Personal Data") under the conditions defined in Appendix 4 of this Contract.

ARTICLE 8: Disputes

This Training Contract is governed by French law.

Any dispute between the Parties that has not been settled amicably will be dealt with by the competent French courts.

ARTICLE 9: Electronic signature

The Parties shall sign this Training Contract using an electronic signature in accordance with the provisions of Articles 1366 et seq. of the French Civil Code, giving it the same evidentiary value as the original signed documents on paper.

This contract consists of Articles 1 to 9 and 4 appendices

- Appendix 1: Program Structure
- Appendix 2: DBA Student Handbook
- Appendix 3: Withdrawal Form
- Appendix 4: Student's personal data protection

For EESC Grenoble Ecole de Management (GEM)

Fouziya BOUZERDA, Director General, Grenoble Ecole de Management

##signature-gem##

The Student,

Jean Philippe Placide Bakala Bounou

##signature-etudiant##

Siège social

12 rue Pierre Sémard
38000 Grenoble - France
Tel : +33 4 76 70 60 60 Fax : +33
4 76 70 60 99
E mail : info@grenoble-em.com
www.grenoble-em.com



Siège social
12 rue Pierre Sépard
38000 Grenoble - France
Tel : +33 4 76 70 60 60 Fax : +33
4 76 70 60 99
E mail : info@grenoble-em.com
www.grenoble-em.com



Appendix 1 – Global DBA Program Structure Intake 2026

Seminar/webinar	Date	Delivery
Seminar 1: Opening Seminar	November 2 nd -6 th 2026	Grenoble
Webinar 1: Implementing the Research Proposal	January 11th 2027	Online 5pm Paris-time
Research Proposal Submission	February 26th 2027	Online submission
Seminar 2: Research Design & Literature Review	March 15th-19th 2027	In-person at GEM or International Hub
Literature Review Submission	September 10th 2027	Online submission
Seminar 3: Research Methods (Qualitative or Quantitative)	October 4th-7th 2027	Paris
Webinar 2: Prepare Dissertation Proposal	November 30 th 2027	Online 5pm Paris-time
Dissertation Proposal Submission	March 10th 2028	Online submission
Webinar 3: Preparing Dissertation Proposal Defense	March 20 th 2028	Online 5pm Paris-time
Dissertation Proposal Defense	April 4th 2028	Online
Seminar 4: Advanced Research Methods (Qualitative or Quantitative)	Jun 26 th -30 th 2028	In-person at GEM or International Hub
Webinar 4: The Road to Final Defence	May 9th 2028	Online 5pm Paris-time
Webinar 5: Academic writing skills	June 19th 2028	Online 5pm Paris-time
Webinar 6: Theoretical Contribution & Impact	October 3 rd 2028	Online 5pm Paris-time
Webinar 7: Managerial Contribution & Impact	February 6th 2029	Online 5pm Paris-time
Webinar 8: Communicating your Research	June 19th 2029	Online 5pm Paris-time
Thesis submission (greenlight from supervisor)	October 31st 2029	

Dates of seminars and webinars are tentative and may be subject to modifications.

Advanced Research Masterclasses

Throughout the program, students can opt to participate in a total of 6 advanced research masterclasses at any stage of their studies. These Masterclasses are designed to enrich their knowledge with frontier research and expand their intellectual horizon.

Appendix 2 – Rules and Regulations



DBA

Student

Handbook

Document valid from 1st November 2026

TABLE OF CONTENTS

1. INTRODUCTION.....	3
1.1. Definitions	3
1.2. Scope of this DBA Student Handbook	4
1.3. Student Status and Rights	4
1.4. Abeyance	5
1.5. Withdrawal from The DBA Programme	6
2. DBA GOVERNANCE STRUCTURE	6
2.1. The Review and Extraordinary Review Committee	6
2.2. Appeals and the Appeal Committee	7
3. THE PROGRAMME	8
3.1. Programme overview	8
3.2. DBA Programme duration and Attendance	8
3.3. Conditions for Granting the Degree	10
3.4. DBA-Related Publications	12
4. SUPERVISION.....	12
4.1. Appointment of the Supervisor	12
4.2. Responsibilities of the Supervisor	13
4.3. Supervisor-Student relationship	13
5. CODE OF CONDUCT	16
5.1. Principles	16
5.2. Plagiarism	17
5.3. Procedures for Unethical Behaviour and Plagiarism	17
6. PHASE 1: DISSERTATION PROPOSAL.....	18
6.1. Training in Doctoral Research in Management Sciences	18
6.2. Development of the Dissertation Proposal	19
6.3. Assessment – Phase 1	22
7. PHASE 2: FINAL THESIS	23
7.1. Overview of the process	23
7.2. Learning Goals and Objectives, Phase 2	25
7.3. Final Thesis content	26
7.4. Appointment of two reviewers	29
7.5. Review process	30
7.6. Authorisation to defend providing minor modifications of the Final Thesis	32
7.7. No authorisation to defend, moderate to significant modifications required	32
7.8. No authorisation to defend, major modifications required	33
7.9. Letter to the Reviewers.....	34
7.10. Appointment of an additional Reviewer	35
7.11. Setting a date for the viva voce	35
7.12. Thesis oral defence (Viva voce)	35
7.13. Viva protocol	36
7.14. Online attendance.....	37
ANNEXES.....	38
Annexe 1. Research Proposal Assessment Grid.....	38
Annexe 2. Literature Review Assessment Grid	42
Annexe 3a. Dissertation Proposal Assessment Grid (Supervisor)	46
Annex 3b. Dissertation Proposal Assessment Grid (Reviewers).....	51
Annex 4a. Final Thesis Assessment Grid (Supervisor)	57
Annex 4b. Final Thesis Preliminary Report (Reviewers)	67
Annexe 5. Joint Report of Viva Voce Thesis Committee	78
Annexe 6. Supervisor Guide	80

1. INTRODUCTION

1.1. Definitions

Academic Director: the academic staff member from Grenoble Ecole de Management appointed to academically supervise The DBA Programme (student recruitment, programme design, supervisor allocation, reviewer appointment) or academic transversal activities beyond The DBA Programme (academic partnership, alumni management)

Appeal Committee: a committee qualified to review a decision made by the Review Committee acting in its disciplinary role. It is composed of the Dean of Faculty, the Director of Research, at least one academic staff member from Grenoble Ecole de Management, the Programme Coordinator and possibly an external academic invited to participate. The Academic Director of the concerned programme presents the cases to the Appeal Committee without participating in the decision. The Appeal Committee is convened by the Director of the Doctoral School.

DBA Programme(s): Global Doctorate of Business Administration programme(s) run by Grenoble Ecole de Management.

Deliverable: written document submitted by the Student at the time specified by the Training Contract. Deliverables include: the Research Proposal, the Literature Review, the Dissertation Proposal, and the Final Thesis (as detailed in the annexes 1, 2, 3 and 4 to these Rules and Regulations).

External Reviewer: a recognized scholar in his or her field of expertise from an academic institution other than Grenoble Ecole de Management.

Extraordinary Review Committee: a Review Committee holding a meeting for or specific urgent matters outside of ordinary times. It is composed of the Director of the Doctoral School, Academic Directors and Programme Coordinators. It is convened by the Director of the Doctoral School. It has an academic and a disciplinary role.

Final Thesis: the full research document written by the Student and approved by the Supervisor for submission to the Doctoral School. Final Thesis contents and assessment criteria are detailed in section 7 of this DBA student handbook and Annexes 4a, 4b and 5.

Greenlight: formal authorisation to submit the Final Thesis granted by the Supervisor. When the greenlight is granted, the Programme Coordinator can send the Final Thesis to Reviewers for review.

Internal Reviewer: an academically qualified academic staff member of Grenoble Ecole de Management.

Programme Coordinator: the professional staff member from Grenoble Ecole de Management in charge of the day-to-day Student relationship (logistics and administrative duties relating to The DBA Programme)

Research Advancement Contract: a binding contract signed between the Student, their Supervisor(s) and the Doctoral School at the beginning of Year 4 in The DBA Programme if Deliverables have not been submitted in time during the first three years. Through this contract, the Student commits to meeting the agreed deadlines for submitting various assignments and Deliverables to the Supervisor.

Review Committee: is composed of the Director of the Doctoral School, Academic Directors, and Programme Coordinators. It is convened by the Director of the Doctoral School. It has an academic and disciplinary role. It meets once a month, except in August.

Seminar: the compulsory training course on Research Methods designed to provide the Student with the research knowledge and skills required to complete a doctoral dissertation

Student: A student enrolled in one of the Grenoble Ecole de Management DBA Programmes and registered as at GEM as such. A Student is identified through a matriculation number assigned on the day of first registration.

Supervisor: the academic staff member from Grenoble Ecole de Management or from another academic institution appointed to guide the Student throughout the research process as described in Annexe 6.

Thesis Committee: a committee convened to evaluate the Final Thesis and oral defence. It is composed of the Academic Director, the Supervisor, and a minimum of one External Reviewer and One Internal reviewer.

Training Contract: Contract signed by Student when enrolling on the DBA Programme.

Viva: *viva voce* or oral defence of the Final thesis before a Thesis Committee. Pursuant to French regulations, the viva is a public event and open to attendance by the public.

Webinar: a 1.5hour compulsory online session on research methods, designed to complement the core research methods learning covered in the seminars

1.2. Scope of this DBA Student Handbook

This DBA student handbook defines the general rules and regulations governing the Grenoble Ecole de Management DBA Programmes.

It also provides the general guidelines designed to ensure the highest quality and consistency of ethical behaviour among the Students.

This DBA student handbook ensures the DBA Programme's continuing conformance with quality assurance standards as defined by Grenoble Ecole de Management and in line with the following international accrediting organizations: the Association to Advance Collegiate Schools of Business (AACSB), the European Quality Improvement System (EQUIS), the Association of MBAs (AMBA), and European Doctoral Programmes Association in Management and Business Administration (EDAMBA).

This DBA student handbook is valid from first enrolment on November 1st 2026 and until DBA Programme completion.

1.3. Student Status and Rights

If all fees have been paid, a DBA Student enjoys the full status of a registered student and therefore has access to all physical and digital student facilities. During the first seminar, the Student will receive an identification number and will be given access to all Grenoble Ecole de Management's facilities, including email system and research databases through the school's online library.

The Student is entitled to be assigned a Supervisor within a month after the first seminar

has taken place. The Student is entitled to regular feedback and advice from Supervisor at all stages of progress in the DBA Programme as described in Section 4.

The Student authorises Grenoble Ecole de Management to use any photographs or videos in which they may appear for the purposes of promotion visibility. This authorisation is granted for any channels and modes of diffusion and for a duration of 10 years after their first registration.

All Students in Grenoble Ecole de Management's DBA Programme are required to regularly update the Doctoral School with details of any publications, presentations, or other activities linked to their doctoral studies. The Student authorises the School to use these materials for the purposes of promotion and visibility. This authorisation is granted for any channels and modes of diffusion.

1.4. Abeyance

For personal or professional reasons, the Student may request from the Academic Director an abeyance period (six months renewable once within the limit of one academic year). The Student notifies the Academic Director and the Programme Coordinator via email. The application for abeyance is examined by the Review Committee; the application cannot be refused providing the Student has met the conditions described below.

Abeyance must be requested no later than 30 days before the end of the semester (end on October 31st or April 30th). Exceptions to this 30-day notice can apply in *Force Majeure* situations. These must be justified; all necessary documents should be sent to the Programme Coordinator via email.

Abeyance officially starts at the beginning of the next semester regardless of the date of the request. Retrospective requests will not be considered. Tuition fees covering the period between the request for abeyance and the official start of the abeyance period are due. Student good financial and administrative standing is a necessary condition for abeyance approval from the Review Committee.

During the abeyance period, Students will not have access to the Grenoble Ecole de Management facilities (including the online library) and will not receive guidance from their Supervisors for their research. Tuition fees are suspended during the abeyance period.

The expected date for submissions will be adjusted pursuant to the duration of abeyance and date of return into the DBA Programme and formalised in an amendment to the Training Contract.

The Student on abeyance must contact the Programme Coordinator via email one month prior to the end of the abeyance period to prepare for their return to The DBA Programme.

Failure by the Student to notify the Programme Coordinator in time of their intention to return into the DBA Programme will result in deregistration from The DBA Programme. Deregistration will result in the impossibility of being reintegrated into The DBA Programme. A new application for the programme will not be considered.

Reintegration into the DBA Programme will be effective upon receipt by Grenoble Ecole de Management of the tuition fees due for the new semester in case of return from abeyance on May 1st or for the whole year in case of return from abeyance on November 1st.

1.5. Withdrawal from The DBA Programme

For personal or professional reasons, Students may choose to withdraw from The DBA Programme. The Student notifies their Supervisor, the Academic Director and the Programme Coordinator of this intention via email. The Review Committee examines the request for withdrawal. Withdrawal from the DBA Programme cannot be refused if the Student is in good academic and financial standing. If the Student is not, they will be deregistered from the DBA Programme. Tuition fees related to the period between the request for withdrawal and the end of the DBA Programme's academic semester remain due, and the payment cannot be postponed.

If the Student has withdrawn from the DBA Programme and would like to be reintegrated, they must formally apply, following the official online application procedure. The Review Committee will examine the application as a new application to The DBA Programme.

If the Student has been deregistered by the Review Committee, they cannot be reintegrated. Any future new application will not be considered.

In the event of the Student is deregistered from the DBA Programme, the Programme Coordinator will notify the Student via registered email to their GEM email address.

2. DBA GOVERNANCE STRUCTURE

The DBA Programmes of Grenoble Ecole de Management are the responsibility of the Doctoral School. The Director of the Doctoral School delegates some of these responsibilities to the following governance bodies.

2.1. The Review and Extraordinary Review Committee

The Review Committee meets once a month and when an Academic Director considers it necessary to review a Student's progress and administrative and pedagogical situations in the DBA Programme.

In the case of an exceptional event that requires further examination, an Extraordinary Review Committee may be convened in its academic or its disciplinary role. In the event where an Extraordinary Review Committee is to be convened, the Doctoral School Coordinator notifies via email the Student whose case is to be examined of the matter to

be discussed and of the date of the meeting 15 days prior.

In such an Extraordinary Review Committee, a minimum of one academic staff member from Grenoble Ecole de Management not involved in DBA Programme management and not linked to the situation investigated will be appointed by the Director of the Doctoral School. The Dean of Faculty or the Dean of Research may be invited to participate in the Extraordinary Review Committee. The outcome of the Extraordinary Review Committee will be communicated to the Student by the Director of the Doctoral School via email within 10 days of the meeting.

More specifically, the Review Committee has the following responsibilities in its academic role:

- monitors progress as described in section 4.3 the formal feedback loop;
- monitors the Student-Supervisor relationship as described in section 4.2;
- validates successful completion of Phase 1 ending with the Dissertation Proposal defence based on the Supervisor's and Reviewers' assessments as described in section 6.2 and annexes 3a and 3b;
- accepts or refuses registration of Students in the DBA Programme for additional years after Year 3 as described in section 3.2;
- In case of split assessments in Phase 2, the Review Committee will appoint an additional Internal Reviewer as described in section 7.10.

The purpose of the Review Committee in its disciplinary role is to look at any failure to comply with the DBA student handbook reported by teaching or administrative staff with regard to a Student.

In its disciplinary role, the Review Committee may decide one or more of the following sanctions:

- Warning;
- Rejection of the Deliverable and obligation to resubmit an original text within a specified timeframe;
- A requirement to compensate for the damage caused to Grenoble Ecole de Management or any other third party;
- Temporary or permanent exclusion.

The Review Committee is sovereign, and as such it is not required to give reasons for the decisions taken during its deliberations. They will be recorded in the Student's file.

2.2. Appeals and the Appeal Committee

The Student has the right to appeal the decision of the Review Committee, except this relating to the validation of Phase 1 (as per section 3.1. of this DBA student handbook).

The appeal must be lodged in writing via email within 10 working days from

communication of the specific Review Committee's decision. To be considered, the Student must provide evidence or documents that were not available at the time of the original Review Committee meeting that support their case.

An Appeal Committee will then meet to review the appeal.

The Programme Coordinator will notify the Student via GEM email of the decision made by the Appeal Committee.

The decision of the Appeal Committee is final and cannot be appealed further. The decision will be recorded in the Student's file.

3. THE PROGRAMME

3.1. Programme overview

The DBA Programme is a three-year programme.

The three-year DBA Programme consists of two main phases:

Phase 1. Approximately 17 months: *Training in Doctoral Research in Management Sciences*: Philosophy, Literature Review, Research Design, Methodology, and Research Tools. During this part of The DBA Programme, the Student must attend three compulsory seminars on the various aspects of research design and related webinars (72 hours of face-to-face class time or online in case of extraordinary circumstances and 12 hours of webinars). The Student must also attend one face-to-face seminar on the methodology relevant for their research (24 hours of face-to-face class time or online in case of extraordinary circumstances). In parallel and with the support of their Supervisor, they must formulate the research question for their DBA thesis, develop the introduction and literature review, define the research design, and prepare the dissertation proposal for defence at the end of Phase 1.

Phase 2. 17 to 36 months: *Writing, Submitting, and Defending the DBA Final Thesis*. In this phase of the DBA Programme the Student finalises data collections and data analyses, completes the writing of the Thesis, submits and defends their work.

3.2. DBA Programme duration and Attendance

The DBA Programme is a three-year programme. Within this time limit, the Student is expected to have received the Greenlight from their Supervisors to submit their Thesis.

The academic year starts with Seminar 1. The minimum duration of the DBA Programme is three years if the Student was admitted in Phase 1 and two years in case of admission directly in Phase 2.

The standard duration of Phase 1 is 17 months. The Review Committee may allow the Student an additional 12 months to complete Phase 1. The maximum duration cannot exceed 29 months, in case of inability to proceed to Phase 2 within that time frame, the Review Committee will proceed to deregistration.

After the Student has defended their Dissertation Proposal, the Review Committee will evaluate progress based on Deliverables and feedback from Reviewers and Supervisor to allow admission into Phase 2.

In case one or more seminar or webinar was not fully completed, the seminar or webinar must be attended in parallel with another cohort or later with the subsequent cohort. The Student will not be admitted to Phase 2 until the compulsory seminars and webinars have been completed.

The standard duration of Phase 2 is 19 months. The Review Committee may allow the Student an additional 12 months to complete Phase 2. The maximum duration cannot exceed 31 months.

The ultimate deadline to receive Greenlight from Supervisor is 31st October in year 3 of the DBA Programme.

If the Student does not receive a Greenlight from the Supervisor, they may make an application to the Review Committee in its academic role to enter Year 4, the Review Committee will require that the Student complete a Research Advancement Contract, this should be signed by the Student and the Supervisor. This Research Advancement Contract is aimed at ensuring that the Thesis can be completed within 4 years.

The Student must submit their Research Advancement Contract to the Review Committee by 15th October in Year 3. The Review Committee may refuse the Student's request. The Academic Director will inform the Student and the Supervisor of the decision. In case of acceptance, the additional year will be formalised in an amendment to the Training Contract.

In exceptional cases where the Student is unable to complete their Thesis within 4 years, the Review Committee may grant a fifth year. The Review Committee will require a revised Research Advancement contract approved by the Supervisor.

The Student must submit their Research Advancement Contract to the by 15th October in Year 4. The Review Committee may refuse the Student's request. The Academic Director will inform the Student and the Supervisor of the decision. In case of acceptance, the additional year will be formalised in an amendment to the Training Contract.

Tuition fees will be payable until the dissertation is approved by the dissertation Reviewers for defence.

The DBA Programme is considered complete when the Student is informed of the viva voce examination outcome.

In case the Student does not receive Greenlight from Supervisors within a maximum timeframe of five years they will be deregistered from The DBA Programme.

In case of abeyance as defined in section 2.2. of this DBA Student Handbook, the abeyance period is not considered part of the five years of part-time study.

3.3. Conditions for Granting the Degree

The Grenoble Ecole de Management Doctoral School defines the learning goals for the Student. These goals are the basis for measuring the extent to which Students have met learning objectives.

To obtain the DBA degree, Students must also write and submit to the Thesis Committee a Thesis that meets doctoral-level standards described in 7.2.

The DBA degree can be granted if the following conditions are met:

- Successful defence of the Dissertation Proposal at the end of Phase 1;
- Attendance of all seminars and compulsory webinars; or, in case of direct admission to Phase 2, equivalent seminars have been attended prior to joining the DBA Programme;
- Viva of the Final Thesis within the timeframe detailed in section 4.2. of this DBA student handbook;
- Good financial standing, no outstanding fees;
- Final thesis submission to the Programme Coordinator after the Viva.

Table 1. DBA Programme overview

Academic Year	Nature	Deliverable	When	Teaching mode	Teaching Hours
Year 1	Seminar 1 Opening Seminar		November	Face-to-face, Grenoble	24 hours
	Webinar 1 Implementing the Research Proposal		January	Online 5 pm CET	2 hours
	Research Proposal Submission	X	End of February	Online submission	
	Seminar 2 Research Design & Literature Review		March	In person at GEM or partner locations (NOTE : this is one location)	24 hours
	Literature Review Submission	X	September	Online submission	
	Seminar 3 Research Methods (Qualitative or Quantitative)		October	Face-to-face, Paris	24 hours
Year 2	Webinar 2 Prepare Dissertation Proposal		End of November	Online 5 pm CET	2 hours
	Dissertation Proposal Submission	X	March	Online submission	
	Webinar 3 Preparing Dissertation Proposal Defense		March	Online 5 pm CET	2 hours
	Dissertation Proposal Defense	X	April	Online	
	Seminar 4 Advanced Research Methods (Qualitative or Quantitative)		End of June	In person at GEM or partner locations (NOTE : this is one location)	18 hours
	Webinar 4 The Road to Final Defence		May	Online 5 pm CET	2 hours
	Webinar 5 Academic writing skills		June	Online 5 pm CET	2 hours
	Webinar 6 Theoretical contribution & impact		October	Online 5 pm CET	2 hours
Year 3	Webinar 7 Managerial Contribution & impact		February	Online 5 pm CET	2 hours

	Webinar 8 Communicating your Research		June	Online 5 pm CET	2 hours
	Thesis submission (Greenlight from supervisor)	X	October		

3.4. DBA-Related Publications

The Student must formally invite his or her former Supervisor to co-sign every publication related to the Thesis even after the granting of the DBA degree. Even though the former Supervisor is not actively contributing after graduation, their contribution lies in the fact that it was enabled through all the guidance, advice and support given to the supervised Student.

Any academic or professional document relating to or proceeding from the DBA Thesis and published before graduation must show the Student's affiliation to Grenoble Ecole de Management as a DBA student. The Supervisor must appear as second author, their contribution lying in their guidance, advice and support given to the supervised Student. Post-graduation publications must acknowledge Grenoble Ecole de Management.

4. SUPERVISION

4.1. Appointment of the Supervisor

The Student is entitled to be assigned a supervisor by the Academic Director within a month after the first seminar.

Requirements to serve as a supervisor in the DBA Programmes are: (1) hold a doctoral degree (PhD/DBA) and/or HDR (French post-doctoral degree that supports supervision of research projects), (2) have published in relevant peer-reviewed journal(s) in the past five years, and (3) have had supervisory experience at the post-graduate level in the previous three years.

Academic staff members from Grenoble Ecole de Management without supervisory experience at post-graduate level may be assigned a senior faculty member acting as a Co-Supervisor.

Supervisors may be academic staff members of Grenoble Ecole de Management, affiliated Supervisors, participating faculty, supporting or visiting faculty, as defined by GEM. They may also belong to the faculties of academic partner institutions. It is the responsibility of Grenoble Ecole de Management to inform Supervisors of supervision rules.

All Supervisors who accept the role of Supervisor must abide by The DBA Programme's rules and regulations. Supervisors are provided with a Supervisor's Guide (see Annex 6)

4.2. Responsibilities of the Supervisor

The Supervisor monitors the ongoing progress of their Student, including evaluating whether their work complies with doctoral standards and abides by ethical guidelines. Therefore, the Supervisor and the Student are required to make contact at least once per month. It is the Student's responsibility to contact their Supervisor and ask for feedback and advice. It is the Student's responsibility to take notes of these meetings or record them if approved by the Supervisor.

If the Student remains out of touch with the Supervisor for longer than a two-month period, it is the Supervisor's responsibility to contact the Student and inform the Academic Director. Supervisors and the Student will keep records of these meetings and share these as required. The Student should send written work to the Supervisor prior to each meeting for feedback.

4.3. Supervisor-Student relationship

In the relation to the Supervisor, the Student is expected to abide by the following principles:

- (1) The Student must be very proactive: define together with the Supervisor regular meetings (phone, skype, etc.), at least one working meeting every month.
- (2) In order to avoid sterile discussions, the Student should submit written material before each meeting
- (3) The Student is responsible for keeping and sharing records on each meeting (emails, date, content of the discussion, etc.)
- (4) If the Student misses a meeting, they should make sure to immediately re-schedule the next with Supervisor. The Student should remind the Supervisor regularly of their timeline and key milestones of the DBA Programme.

In Phase 1, the Supervisor's key responsibilities are as follows:

1. Advise the Student regarding the research question definition, overall research design, including literature review, theoretical/conceptual framework and research design;
2. Review written materials received from the Student and provide written feedback; assess and provide feedback to the Student and grade each Deliverable; and send a copy of this assessment to the Academic Director and the Programme Coordinator (See Table 1); and
3. Complete evaluations and provide feedback outlined in Table 2.

In Phase 2 the Supervisor's key responsibilities are as follows:

1. Advise the Student regarding research methodology, data collection, and data analysis;
2. Review written materials received from the Student and provide written feedback to the Student (See Table 1);
3. Determine whether the Student is ready to submit a Final Thesis, complete the Intention to Submit form, and officially ask the Academic Director to initiate the Review process;
4. Suggest potential Reviewers according to their academic qualifications and their interest in the DBA research topic; and
5. Complete evaluations when necessary.

The participation of the Supervisor in the oral defence is not compulsory, but Supervisors are welcome as guests. The Supervisor has a consultative role and non-decisional in nature during the review process, the Viva and the post-Viva deliberation.

The Student cannot expect their Supervisor to:

1. Undertake the actual research itself;
2. Collect data in their place;
3. Analyse data in their place;
4. Write or significantly redraft papers or chapters;
5. Conduct a detailed proof read of the thesis.

Table 2. Formal Feedback Points

	Formal Feedback Given to Student	Form
Year 1	Research Proposal and Literature Review	Evaluation completed by the Supervisor and shared with the Student & Academic Director Doctoral School
Year 2	Dissertation Proposal	Evaluation completed by the Supervisor & evaluation from Phase 1 Reviewers shared with the Student & Academic Director

Year 3	Progress Evaluation or Thesis submission	Progress Evaluation form completed by the Supervisor and shared with the Student & Doctoral School Thesis submission: evaluation completed by the Supervisor & Phase 1 Reviewers shared with the Student & the Academic Director prior to Viva.
Year 4	Thesis Defence or Research Advancement Contract	Oral examination completed by a Thesis Committee. Research Advancement Contract completed by the Student and approved by the Supervisor presented to the Review Committee by the Academic Director; it is subject to approval or refusal from the Review Committee.
Year 5	Thesis Defence or Research Advancement Contract	Oral examination completed by a Thesis Committee. Research Advancement Contract completed by the Student and approved by the Supervisor presented to the Review Committee by the Academic Director; it is subject to approval or refusal from the Review Committee.

Should the Supervisor or the Student express a problem or difficulty that will directly impact upon the Student's studies, the concerned Party should bring these concerns via email to the Academic Director's attention. The Academic Director meets both Parties. If a solution cannot be found, the Parties will be informed via email that the case will be presented before the next Review Committee in its academic role. The Review Committee will examine the case and take any measures necessary to resolve the issue. In case of a change in supervision being required to resolve the issue, the Academic Director will notify via email both the Student and the former Supervisor. The Academic Director will introduce via email the Student to the newly appointed Supervisor. The Student is not consulted in the choice of a new Supervisor and cannot refuse the newly nominated Supervisor.

The Student is also encouraged to attend research conferences, seminars or workshops beyond those proposed in The DBA Programme.

5. CODE OF CONDUCT

By starting a Grenoble Ecole de Management DBA Programme, the Students undertake to:

1. Respect others (students, trainees, professionals, teachers, GEM staff, partners, visitors, neighbors, etc.) and be courteous in all circumstances, whether by direct contact or email. No discriminatory, racist or sexist comments or acts will be tolerated (see paragraph "Respect for others"). No harm to the physical or moral integrity of the people with whom the Student interacts during the course will be tolerated.
2. Formally comply with the Règles de sécurité de Grenoble Ecole de Management (Grenoble School of Management safety rules) (online on the Student Portal), the Student Personal Data Protection Rules, computer security rules as defined in the Charter for the use of the resources of the Grenoble Ecole de Management Information and Communication System for GEM learners), Exit Examination Regulations
3. Respect the procedures and decisions in the different pathways and courses of The DBA Programme
4. Respect the guidelines set out in the most recent version of the "GEM Student Academic Integrity Guide", in all academic work conducted during the duration of their enrollment at GEM
5. Convey a professional image in any contact with the business world but also in the context of courses, internships, partnerships, charitable activities, or any other event, taking place on GEM's premises, or those of its partners, as well as outside GEM, and notably on social networks. In this respect, the Student undertakes to not harm the image of GEM.
6. Submit all requested documents and personal data of an administrative nature on the dates requested and keep them up to date.
7. Obtain daily information about their studies through the Student Portal, their email AND on GEMunity/Yammer.
8. Always carry their student card to access GEM's premises, and to not give it to anyone else under penalty of sanctions.
9. Respect the premises and equipment available to them.
10. To not leave personal belongings unattended. GEM shall not be held liable in the event of theft of said items.

5.1. Principles

Grenoble Ecole de Management has a strict ethical policy. Any breach thereof results in disciplinary actions.

The Doctoral School understands that in certain cultures, the giving of gifts is normal practice; however, in compliance with French legislation, the management, academic directors, and supervisors of the Doctoral School are not permitted to accept gifts.

GEM is committed to providing a safe learning environment that is free from violence, harassment and intimidation for every member of the GEM community. No words or actions that compromise another person's dignity will be tolerated.

A grievance procedure is available for any person who is submitted to witnesses such behaviour. Complaints must be submitted via www.grenoble-em.signalement.net

The report can lead to disciplinary action if decided by Review Committee in its disciplinary role.

Further information about the grievance procedure is available via the student portal at <https://mailboxgrenobleem.sharepoint.com/sites/IntranetEtudiant/en/student-life/Pages/Alert.aspx>

5.2. Plagiarism

Grenoble Ecole de Management has a strict policy that prohibits all plagiarism and enforces the attendant procedures and measures of control.

Plagiarism—defined as “the wrongful appropriation or purloining and publication as one’s own, of the ideas, or the expression of the ideas ... of another” (Oxford English Dictionary, 1999)—is a major offence. Grenoble Ecole de Management relies on the knowledge and skills of its research supervisors in their respective fields to detect fraud. If in doubt, the Academic Director requests via email that the Programme Coordinator should organise an Extraordinary Review Committee in its disciplinary role.

The Doctoral School also uses TURNITIN® (or equivalent) software as an additional tool to detect plagiarism. Evidence of plagiarism invokes the following responses:

Evidence of intentional plagiarism in any document and Deliverable (e.g., research proposal, literature review, dissertation proposal, final dissertation, or papers submitted to a journal or conference, without any restriction) produced by a Student can lead to the offender’s final and deregistration from The DBA Programme.

Intellectual honesty goes beyond plagiarism issues, and any other evidence of cheating or ethical misconduct (e.g., falsified diploma or falsified data collection or analysis, or other ethical misconduct) will trigger the same procedure and outcomes.

5.3. Procedures for Unethical Behaviour and Plagiarism

Any unethical behaviour, or behaviour that could be perceived as unethical, should be reported to the Academic Director or Director of the Doctoral School.

Any breach, or perceived breach of the ethical policy will be assessed by the Review Committee. In the event such a breach is suspected or noted, the Academic Director requests via email that the Doctoral School Coordinator should organise an Extraordinary Review Committee in its disciplinary role. The Doctoral School Coordinator notifies the Student concerned via email at least 15 calendar days prior to the committee meeting to share the date of the meeting. The Student concerned can attend the meeting in person or by video link. The Student can be assisted by one person

The Extraordinary Review Committee will examine the circumstances and make a decision pertaining to the alleged incident or misconduct and take appropriate measures. In the

case of plagiarism or a breach of ethical policy, the Extraordinary Review Committee will determine if the act was intentional or represented an unintentional error. The Director of the Doctoral School will inform the Student by email of any decisions, conditions or sanctions.

After investigating the case and hearing the Student, the Review Committee takes disciplinary actions. The decision made by the Review Committee can be appealed as detailed in section 3.2. of this DBA student handbook.

The Extraordinary Review Committee may decide one or more of the following sanctions:

- Warning;
- Rejection of the concerned Deliverable or document and obligation to resubmit an original text within a specified timeframe;
- A requirement to compensate for the damage caused to Grenoble Ecole de Management or any other third party;
- Temporary or permanent exclusion.

6. PHASE 1: DISSERTATION PROPOSAL

Phase 1 lasts approximately 17 months and cannot exceed 29 months. It is comprised of 4 seminars in Doctoral Research in Management Sciences: Philosophy, Literature Review, Research Design, Methodology, and Research Tools. It consists of two major activities: (1) training in research methodologies, (2) development and writing of the Dissertation Proposal.

6.1. Training in Doctoral Research in Management Sciences

Training activities aim to give the Student the necessary knowledge and skills to perform rigorous research that meets doctoral-level standards and to develop productive collaborations with the Supervisor.

Course Overview

During Phase 1 of the DBA Programme, the Student must attend a series of courses given during the training seminars and webinars. The seminars and webinars represent at least 100.5 hours of lectures. These include the following topics: Introduction to Research Methods and Doctoral Research, Research Design and Literature Review, Qualitative or Quantitative Data Collection, Qualitative or Quantitative Data Analysis, and Advanced Data Analysis in either Qualitative or Quantitative research methods.

Upon enrolment in the DBA Programme, the Student receives full information about the locations and dates of the seminars. Seminars may be adapted to a hybrid structure (offered both in-person and live online) depending on global travel conditions.

Course Attendance

During Phase 1 of the DBA Programme, course attendance is mandatory. The Student cannot defend their dissertation proposal before they have participated in all scheduled

seminars and webinars. Except for webinars and for those seminars explicitly taught online, physical attendance is the general rule.

In case of exceptional circumstances averting physical attendance, and provided these could be duly justified with all the necessary documentation sent to the Programme Coordinator and the Academic Director via email, the Student must attend the same seminar or webinar with another intake of the GEM DBA programme portfolio.

If this substitution is not possible, the Student must attend the unattended seminar or webinar with the intake of the following year.

The Dissertation Proposal will be defended only after completion of seminar and webinar attendance. In the interim, the Student continues working on their Thesis with their Supervisor.

To guarantee fair and equal conditions for all Students travelling to and from the DBA seminars, the Student may neither leave early nor arrive late for any seminar or webinar. The dates for the seminars and webinars will be communicated well in advance so Students can make all the necessary arrangements. Any hours missed due to late arrivals, absences, or early departures may need to be made up in a future seminar and could delay the passage through Phase 1 and Dissertation Proposal defence.

Preparation for Classes and Assessment

For each seminar, the Student may be required to perform preparatory or follow-up work. In this case, assignments must be submitted no later than the deadline set by the seminar teacher.

6.2. Development of the Dissertation Proposal

The Dissertation Proposal provides evidence of the Student's achievement of the learning objectives.

Deliverables

Phase 1 must include three deliverables:

1. the Research Proposal (standard duration: 4-5 months from first enrolment);
2. the Literature Review (standard duration: 8-9 months from first enrolment); and
3. the Dissertation Proposal (standard duration: 15-16 months from first enrolment).

The Student has 16 months after enrolling in The DBA Programme to submit their Dissertation Proposal (the precise date will be established by the Academic Director). This Dissertation Proposal must be sent via email to the Academic Director, the Supervisor and the Programme Coordinator at least 21 days before the defence date. The Research Proposal and a draft of the Literature Review are intermediate steps and must have previously been submitted to and formally assessed by the Supervisor. Students should

submit the Research Proposal, Literature Review and Dissertation Proposal to Turnitin®.
The general schedule is outlined in Table 3.

Table 3. General DBA Programme Schedule for Phase 1

Deadline	Deliverable	Recipient	Assessment
Month +5	Research proposal	Supervisor (copy Academic Director and Programme Coordinator)	Assessment by the Supervisor
Month +9	Literature Review	Supervisor (copy Academic Director and Programme Coordinator)	Assessment by the Supervisor
Month +16	Dissertation Proposal	Programme Coordinator and Supervisor	Assessment by the Review Committee based on formal feedback from (a) two Reviewers and (b) the Supervisor

Content of the Deliverables for Phase 1

The **Research Proposal** (± 2 000words) must include:

- Topic
- Knowledge claim
 - Research question:
One question ending with a question mark
Research question triple motivation
 - Personal motivation
 - Professional motivation (why does this question bother practitioners?)
 - Academic motivation (to what community?)
 - Intuition of a possible answer to this question and where this intuition is coming from
- Means of answering research question
 - Empirical material required/needed
 - Empirical material availability and accessibility
 - Possible methodology for data collection (roughly, as per module in seminar 1)

- Expected impact
 - How can the thesis be pertinent to practitioners interested in the question?
- How could the thesis be utilised by candidate in his or her managerial practice / work? Or how could the thesis help the candidate's professional development?

This Deliverable is the same for traditional and paper-based theses.

The **Literature Review** ($\pm 10\,000$ words) provides a critical analysis of scientific knowledge in the pertinent research field. This written document should highlight existing research gaps and must be accompanied by a reference list (APA style).

This literature review will be updated all along the DBA journey, but this first milestone helps the Student deepen knowledge in the Student's research field. It is the continuity of the first Deliverable, i.e., the Research Proposal. As such it should cover:

- Key constructs definitions
- State of the art of the literature and addressed community
- What the main streams of thought on the topic are and how they position themselves vis-à-vis each other
- On what do researchers agree or disagree in relation to the topic?
- Gap in the literature: academic motivation for the thesis
- What is known and what needs knowing on the topic?
- Justified and well-designed theoretical framework (qualitative) /or hypotheses (quantitative). This deliverable is the same for traditional and paper-based theses.

The **Dissertation Proposal** ($\pm 15\,000$ words) must include

1. a brief introduction and problem statement;
2. the definitive research question and its justification (from both managerial and academic point of view); an improved literature review and outline of research gaps;
3. the research design; and
4. the feasibility of the empirical study and outlines key issues.

If the Student is preparing a **paper-based thesis**, one of the Student's articles can be included in the preliminary thesis, but the compulsory content outlined above must also be included.

The structure of a Phase 1 paper-based thesis should include

1. a brief introduction and problem statement;
2. the overall research question and its justification (the critical literature review,

which is not present in the article but is necessary to highlight the research gaps, should be detailed in this chapter);

3. the overall research design of the thesis and how the three articles relate to the research question; and
4. one or two publications in progress, depending on their stage of development.

6.3. Assessment – Phase 1

The Student must submit a Dissertation Proposal to the Programme Coordinator and the Supervisor. The formal twofold assessment features an assessment of the Dissertation Proposal by the Supervisor and in parallel a formal joint assessment by two Internal Reviewers. The formal assessment by the two Internal Reviewers takes place during the Dissertation Proposal defence. This assessment by the two Internal Reviewers is twofold: (1) oral feedback on the presented work, (2) a report on the written document and oral presentation submitted to the Academic Director.

The assessment by the two Internal Reviewers is not communicated to the Student immediately. Each report is examined by the Review Committee in its academic role. Based upon the twofold assessment from the two Internal Reviewers and the Supervisor, the Review Committee decides whether the Student may proceed to Phase 2.

In the event the two Internal Reviewers recommend that the Student should not proceed to Phase 2, the Review Committee will decide that the Student must resubmit a revised Dissertation Proposal within the timeframe recommend by the Review Committee. The revised Dissertation Proposal will be assessed by only one of the two Internal Reviewers, the Reviewer will be appointed by the Review Committee. No oral defence is required. Upon receipt of the second assessment, the Review Committee in its academic role decides whether the Student is allowed to proceed to Phase 2.

If, based upon recommendations from the Internal Reviewer assessing the revised Dissertation Proposal, the Review Committee considers that the Student has not achieved the required standard at Phase 1, the Student will not be allowed to continue on the DBA Programme. Pursuantly, the Student will be deregistered from the DBA Programme. In case he or she decides to apply to the DBA Programme anew, the application will not be considered. The Review Committee will award the Student a *Certificate of Research in Management Science*.

The procedure usually follows the timeline described in Table 3. In other cases, the Review Committee will make appropriate decisions described in Table 4.

Table 4. DBA Thesis Timeline and Procedure for Phase 1

DEADLINE	TASK
Twenty-one (21) days before the defence	Student sends the Dissertation Proposal to the Supervisor and Programme Coordinator. Students should submit the Research Proposal, Literature Review and Dissertation Proposal to Turnitin® and send the similarity report to the Programme Coordinator.

Before the Phase 1 defence	Supervisor provides the feedback form to the Programme coordinator.
Dissertation Proposal defence	According to a schedule provided in advance, the Student defends their work before two Reviewers. The Reviewers must read the Dissertation Proposal before the defence and prepare questions. The defence should last approximately 45 minutes: 1. 20 minutes for the presentation with a maximum of 8 to 10 slides ; 2. 15 minutes for questions/answers; and 3. 10 minutes for feedback
Four to six weeks after the defence	The Review Committee meets to summarize the assessments and determine whether the Student will 1. Be admitted to Phase 2; 2. Submit to a new Dissertation Proposal. The Review Committee will make a decision and suggest an appropriate time frame, given the amount of work required by the Dissertation Proposal defence panel

The Student who has passed Phase 1 receive a *Certificate of Research in Management Science*.

7. PHASE 2: FINAL THESIS

7.1. Overview of the process

Table 5. The process

Steps	Student	Supervisor	Academic Director	Programme Coordinator
A. Finalisation of the Thesis	Writes the final document according to format guidelines under the Supervisor's guidance	- Provides scientific guidance - Authorises to release to review (email to the Academic Director & Programme	Responds requesting thesis abstract & DBA entry form	- Checks that the administrative situation is up to date. - Sends Supervisor learning goals evaluation

		Coordinator)		
B. Submission of the Thesis	- Sends the thesis to the Academic Director - Sends the DBA entry form, thesis & abstract to the Programme Coordinator - Uploads the document on Moodle for a Turnitin check	Completes the learning goals evaluation	- Acknowledges receipt of the document - Uses Turnitin for similarity analysis - Checks the thesis' readiness for review (according to formal requirements)	- Receives the thesis, the DBA entry form, the abstract, Turnitin's evaluation - Enters greenlight in easi
C. Choice of the Thesis Committee	May discuss ideas for potential reviewers with the Supervisor	Discusses the choice of Thesis Committee with the Academic Director	Discusses the Thesis Committee choice with the Supervisor	
D. Appointment of the Thesis Committee	Has no contact with the Thesis Committee	Has no contact with the Thesis Committee	Contacts the Thesis Committee and validates their acceptance	- Contacts the Thesis Committee and starts the administrative process - Informs the Student of the Thesis Committee members
E. Review	Has no contact with the Thesis Committee	Has no contact with the Thesis Committee	If necessary reviews the reports of Reviewers and provides additional advice	- Receives the Reviewers' reports within 4 weeks - Sends the two Reports to the Student and the Supervisor when both received
F. Modifications	- Sees details 8.8 for major/minor modifications - Writes a detailed letter to the Reviewers	Provides guidance on the modifications		Receives the modified Thesis and letter to the Reviewers and sends both documents to Reviewers
G. Authorisation to defend	Prepares the presentation with Supervisor's guidance	Provides guidance on the presentation		- Schedules a defence date and updates e@SI - Checks on-site/online presence of the Thesis Committee
H. Viva	Presents and discusses	Has the option of attending (not compulsory, but recommended)¹	Chairs the Thesis Committee	- Organises the defence logistics - Prepares the diploma
Post-viva modifications	<i>If applicable, the Student will provide minor modifications within the timeframe set by the jury</i>	<i>Provides guidance on the modifications</i>		<i>Receives the final version and validates with the Internal Reviewer that it conforms to the request</i> <i>Sends the diploma to the Student</i> <i>Sends the Thesis to the library</i>

7.2. Learning Goals and Objectives, Phase 2

At the end of Phase 2, the Student should meet the following criteria:

Goal 1: The Student has acquired the working knowledge in research design and methods necessary to undertake independent scholarly research
LO 1.1) Is capable of (re)defining and (re)stating a main research question
LO 1.2) Is capable of justifying the research questions from both practical and theoretical perspectives
LO 1.3) Has preliminary understanding about the main research designs available in business research
LO 1.4) The document explicitly presents a research gap and a research question
LO 1.5) The empirical study is feasible (data accessibility, data collection calendar, student methodological skills)
LO 1.6) Is able to choose methods aligned with the research question and theoretical framework
LO 1.7) Is able to adequately perform the data analyses techniques relevant to his/her research
Goal 2: The Student has acquired a 'state of the art' understanding of theories and practices in his/her area of research
LO 2.1) Has preliminary understandings of key theories relevant to the research topic
LO 2.2) Can articulate at a preliminary level the existing research gaps in the relevant literature
LO 2.3) The document reveals the understanding of existing academic knowledge, theories and debates on the topic
LO 2.4) Is capable of adequately reviewing theories applicable to the organisational issue
LO 2.5) The document reveals the ability to integrate existing academic knowledge and theories into a doctoral project
LO 2.6) Is able to justify the articulating of a theoretical framework derived from the literature and consistent with the research question
Goal 3: The DBA Final Thesis contributes to practitioner knowledge and/or academic research
LO 3.1) Is capable of writing an original, rigorous and relevant piece of research on its own (research paper, doctoral thesis...) according to academic standards
LO 3.2) The document is written in a formal, academic style Yes/No
LO 3.3) Research findings can be disseminated through appropriate communication channels (peer-reviewed journal, peer-reviewed conference, professional conference, book...)
LO 3.4) Is able to discuss academic implications and limitations of his/her research
Goal 4: The Student work reflects understanding or knowledge of ethical practices in research (collaboration, plagiarism, authorship, data integrity, confidentiality, data privacy)
LO 4) Is able to evaluate the issue associated with ethical practices in research and higher education (collaboration with other researchers, plagiarism...) Yes/No
Goal 5: The Student's work proposes practical solutions to significant organizational or societal issues, and grounds these solutions in current research and theory
LO 5.1) Is able to justify that the thesis is timely, pertinent and potentially impactful for organizations, management or society
LO 5.2) Is capable of adequately reviewing theories that could be applied to the organisational issue
LO 5.3) Is able to propose solution(s) based upon his or her ability to combine theory and practice
LO 5.4) Is able to anticipate the possible use that could be made of his or her research

7.3. Final Thesis content

Case 1: Traditional thesis (monograph)

Each thesis is an individual and unique piece of work; however, this document must follow the recommended format, respect the word limits (45,000 to 50,000 words),¹ and at least include

1. an abstract specifying research background, research objectives, methodology, and key findings (according to format in abstract guidelines);
2. an acknowledgment page;
3. an introductory chapter that presents the research question and its justification;
4. a literature review that summarizes scientific and managerial knowledge in the field of interest based on the research question and builds towards the candidate's original conceptual framework;
5. a discussion and presentation of the research methodology;
6. a chapter that presents the results and discusses the key findings;
7. a chapter that presents and discusses both the managerial implications of the research and its theoretical contributions*; and
8. a conclusive chapter outlining the key findings, potential biases and limitations of the research, as well as recommendations for further research and directions for follow-up studies.

*Grenoble Ecole de Management emphasises that the managerial contributions are key in the DBA Programme and thus should be substantially covered in the final document (minimum eight pages).

Case 2: Paper-based thesis

DBA theses at Grenoble Ecole de Management can be *paper-based*, meaning that they integrate articles that are either published or at the publishable level. Generally,

1. the thesis should include three distinct papers;
2. at least one out of the three papers should be **empirical in nature** (i.e. it presents data from the student's original data collection and data analysis) and deemed publishable in an academic journal
3. the 2 other papers should be published or accepted for publication
4. the papers may be coauthored, but the Student should be *first author* on at least *two* of the three papers; and

The structure of the paper-based thesis should present:

1. an abstract that specifies the research background, research objectives, methodology, and key findings (according to format in thesis guidelines);

¹ Any thesis of less than 45,000 words or more than 50,000 must be checked and validated by the Review Committee before proceeding to review and viva voce.

2. an acknowledgments page;
3. an introductory chapter of 3,500 words minimum that explains the subject and the research question(s) of each paper and presents the state-of-the-art literature not included in the articles but necessary to the comprehension of the overall thesis. It also details the linkages between the three articles and presents the overall coherence of the document;
4. a chapter on the *Overall Research Design & Methodology* that is used to answer the research questions of the papers;
5. the three articles themselves, each preceded by an *explanatory note* that details how the article makes a contribution to research or to practice by presenting each article's target publication outlet and its 'lifecycle';
6. a *general conclusion* of 3,500 words minimum including the main theoretical contributions, limits of the research, and recommendations for future research.

Table 6 provide the deliverables for Phase 2 for a paper-based thesis

Table 6. Deliverables: Type 1Up to two of the listed deliverables (publication or attendance) is **REQUIRED** in addition to **ONE** publishable academic paper

	Examples	Proof Required	Additional Comments
1. Peer-reviewed conference paper presentation	Paper presented at annual Academy of Management conference or another highly recognized academic conference (for validation, please inform the program director, who will seek validation by the Review Committee)	Conference program with your name and session-specific information (name of session, conveners, date of presentation, etc.).	You may subsequently publish the proceedings or publish this conference paper, but the publication of your conference paper <i>cannot count as either deliverable 2 or 3</i> because it is the same paper and not a freestanding paper significantly different than the presentation at the conference.
2. Chapter published in a book	Chapter published/accepted for publication in a collective work on your thesis topic in the management discipline	Publication acceptance receipt from publisher/lead editor(s) of the work, acceptance notification of your chapter for a call for papers on a given topic, ISBN number, URL link to article online, or other form of proof	It is best to work with editors at well-circulated publishing houses (Routledge, Sage, university presses, etc.) to be sure that your work will be listed and well-referenced online and in research databases.
3. Article published in a managerial review or practitioner journal	Article accepted for publication in a recognized practitioner-oriented journal, such as <i>California Management Review</i> , <i>Engaged Management Review</i> , <i>Business and Management Horizons</i> , <i>Harvard Business Review</i> , <i>Sloan Management Review</i> , or any other well-recognized industry-specific publication	Publication acceptance receipt from manuscript central/journal editors of your manuscript, publication acceptance notification of your article for a call for papers on a given topic, ISBN number, URL link to article online, or other form of proof	Managerial and sector- and industry-specific publications and other specialized journals can be an excellent way to get your research pipeline started and give yourself some visibility. You must check with your supervisor and program director when making a choice on the suitability of a managerial or practitioner-oriented publication.
4. Full-length case study based on your data collection	A full-length case study based on data collected in an empirical field of study/site that should in some way be included in the case (statistical evidence, excerpts/quotes from key informants/interviewees, etc.). A teaching note should accompany the case submitted to, for example, the Case Center at Cranfield University, Ivey Case Publishing, or Harvard Business Publishing, etc.	Publication acceptance receipt from case study publishing editor(s), publication acceptance notification of case, proof of submission, and entry of case in an annual case study <i>competition</i> (Case Centre, Ivey, EFMD, etc.).	If using the case study methodology for your project, follow the format for cases used in business school teaching. Various schools and organizations, such as the Case Centre, Ivey Business School Publishing, have their own guidelines for full-length cases; therefore, you should decide with your supervisor and program director which publication outlet to target your case.
5. Practitioner conference paper presentation	Paper presented at a practitioner conference such as Harvard-affiliated Institute of Coaching annual conference, etc.	Conference program with your name and session-specific information (name of session, conveners, date of presentation, etc.).	You may subsequently publish the proceedings or publish this conference paper, but the publication of your conference paper <i>cannot count as either deliverable 2 or 3</i> because it is the same paper and not a freestanding paper significantly different than the presentation at the conference.
6. Institutional working paper	White papers or reports endorsed by institutions such as the World Bank, IMF, the European Commission, etc.	Publication acceptance or notification receipt	

For the academic paper in particular:

- The targeted journal must be explicitly specified including its rank in the ABS journal list;
- The Supervisor as co-author guarantees that the paper is ready for submission;
- In case the paper has already been submitted to a journal the Student provides evidence from the editor's office that it was not desk-rejected.

Once the required level for the submitted papers has been established, the complete Final Thesis will be examined by the Thesis Committee, and the usual process of defence as detailed in the Phase 2 Guide is followed.

Articles published before graduation must show the Student's affiliation to Grenoble Ecole de Management as a DBA student. Articles published after graduation should acknowledge Grenoble Ecole de Management.

Because it is expected the supervisor(s) have provided the guidance and support necessary to submit papers to ranked peer-reviewed journals, Students are advised to include their Supervisor(s) as co-authors for the papers submitted.

If the same research data is used in two or more articles, it is necessary to transparently employ substantially different theoretical approaches and analyses and to inform the journals, the readers, and all stakeholders of this. It has become a common practice in academia to share data, and the Doctoral School strongly recommends sharing those data with reviewers and/or journals.

7.4. Appointment of two reviewers

The Academic Director appoints one External Reviewer and one Internal Reviewer and may consult with the Supervisor to choose them.

If there is no qualified faculty member at GEM working in the same field, the Academic Director may appoint, as an exception, another active researcher acting as Internal Reviewer.

The Academic Director should take care when appointing Reviewers to ensure there is neither a conflict of interest nor a perceived conflict of interest. Conflicts of interest may include, but are not limited to, close research collaboration or joint publications between the Reviewer(s) and Supervisor or Student; close personal relationships between the Reviewer(s) and Supervisor or Student; or an existing or potential interest in the outcome of the research on the part of the Reviewer(s).

The Student will be informed of the name of the Reviewers by the Programme Coordinator.

Once appointed, no Reviewer can be disqualified. A Reviewer may decide to withdraw from the review process. None of the Review Committee, the Academic Director, the Supervisor, or the Student may exclude a Reviewer even in the case of the appointment of a third Reviewer (see 8.8).

Once the Reviewers have been appointed and are in the process of reviewing the Thesis, there should be no direct contact whatsoever between them and the Student or the Supervisor. Any communication with them prior to the viva must go through the intermediary of the Academic Director.

7.5. Review process

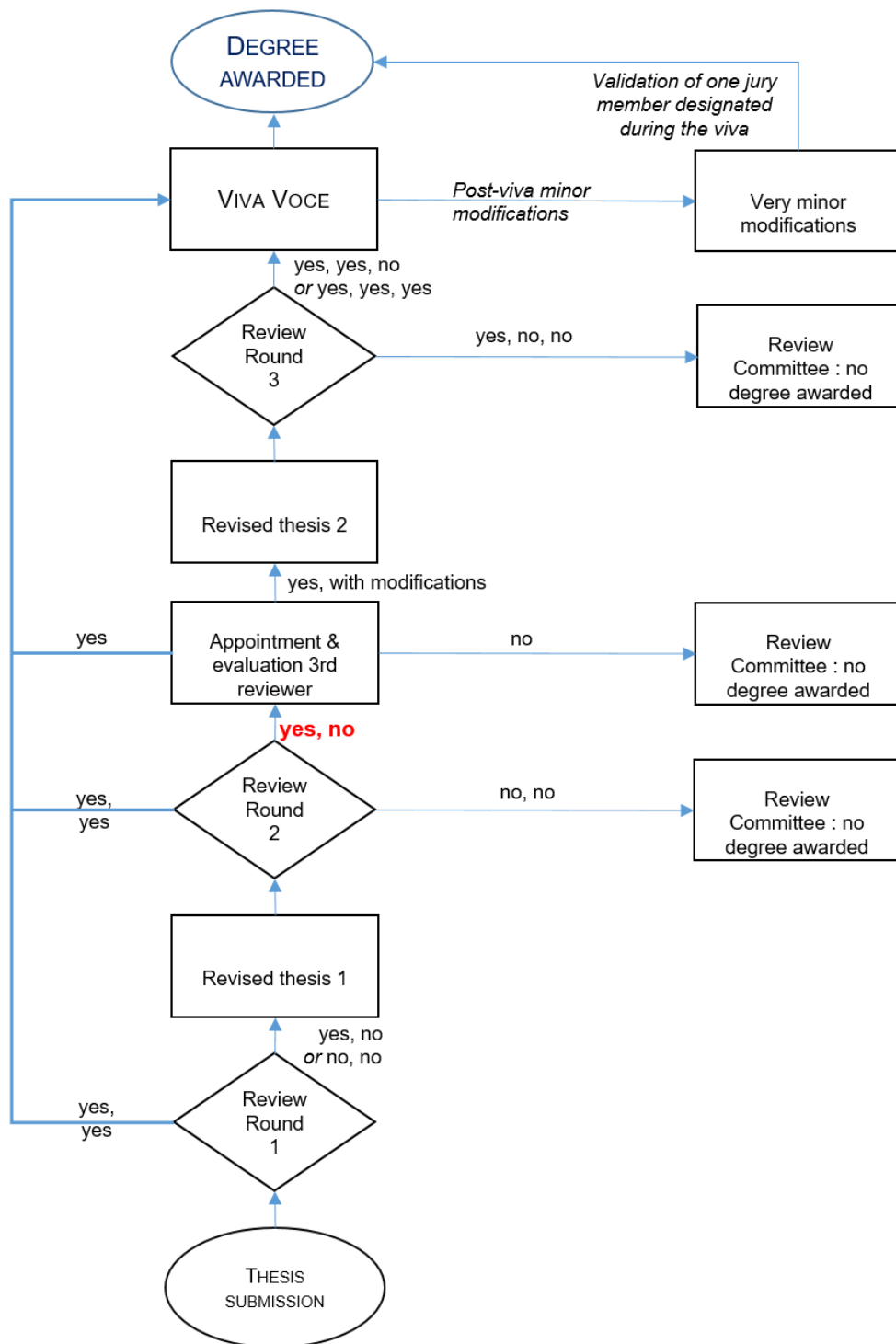
The two Reviewers must assess the quality of the Final Thesis and write a formal report within four weeks of reception of the manuscript. Following their review, they have the authority to decide upon:

- Authorisation to defend the Thesis as submitted: a date can be set by the Programme Coordinator for the Viva to take place;
- Authorisation to defend providing minor modifications of the Thesis (see 8.6);
- No authorisation to defend, major modifications requested (see 8.7); or
- Rejection of the Thesis: in this case, the Review Committee meet in order to take appropriate actions.

In the case of split evaluations, the Academic Director will consult with the Review Committee and provide guidance to the Student and Supervisor, indicating which review is prioritized. Example: one reviewer authorizes the defence without modifications, while the other reviewer requires minor modifications. The Academic Director will confirm the authorisation to defend and will ask the Student to provide minor modifications, even if these are requested by only one Reviewer.

A copy of the Reviewers' reports will be sent prior to the Viva Oral examination process to the Student and the Supervisor so the Student may prepare adequately for the oral defence.

The figure below represents the steps and possible outcomes of each step.



7.6. Authorisation to defend providing minor modifications of the Final Thesis

Minor modifications may be linked to the format, title, abstract, additions of minor literature, referencing, bibliography, expansion of managerial implications, clarification of methods, etc. See Annexe 4b.

The minor modifications should be possible to complete within **one month to three months**. The Student should discuss the timing feasibility of these minor modifications with the Supervisor and, if necessary, the Academic Director. At that time, the Programme Coordinator can begin to schedule a date for the Viva within a reasonable timeframe (a minimum of six weeks) after confirmation from the Student of the specific date when the modifications will be provided.

At least two weeks before the Viva voce, the Student must provide the new version of the final Thesis and the letter to the Reviewer(s) with details of the modifications, including page numbers.

Both documents must be sent by email to the Academic Director and the Programme Coordinator (who will send it to the Reviewers). If the updated Final Thesis is not submitted two weeks prior to the defence date, the Viva may be cancelled. The Reviewers do not formally review the new modified thesis.

YES with no modification or minor modifications

- ☐ a. Proceed to viva with no modifications or
- ☐ b. Authorization to defend providing minor modifications
- Modifications must be completed before Viva.
- Student shall provide:
 - A point-by-point statement of responses to reviewer's comments;
 - A complete list of modifications; including page number(s) where modifications appear
 - A clean copy of the thesis, **no later than 2 weeks prior to the viva**.
- No formal review required by the Reviewers before the Viva.
 - The modifications will be discussed during the Viva.
 - If unsatisfactory, further modifications will be required before issuing the degree certificate

7.7. No authorisation to defend, moderate to significant modifications required

Final Thesis has partially fulfilled expected prerequisites of doctoral-level research but still needs a number of modifications. See Annexe 4b.

Significant modifications can be regarding substantial changes to literature; substantial changes to structure; change to style of text (i.e., more critical or more academic); new data collection; need to change some aspects of the methodology used, revisions, change or refocus of the theoretical framework; clarification of research question (with fundamental change to structure of the thesis), etc.

The modifications should be made by the Student within a **maximum six months**. The Student should discuss with the Supervisor and, if necessary, the Academic Director the feasibility of these major modifications within this timeframe.

Once the modifications are provided, the Student must resubmit the thesis to the Academic Director (copy the Supervisor and the Programme Coordinator) with a letter to the Reviewers (see section 7.9 description of the letter to the Reviewers).

The Reviewers restart the review process and have four weeks to evaluate the new version of the Final Thesis. They may authorise (with minor modifications or without modifications) the defence or refuse it.

If both Reviewers decide that the Final Thesis is not acceptable, the Student can be judged to have failed. The Review Committee, acting in its academic role, will take appropriate action (see Section 7.5 Review Process: Rejection of the thesis).

7.8. No authorisation to defend, major modifications required

The Final Thesis has not met expected level required of doctoral research. Certain key aspects of the Thesis are subject to revisions (linked to research question, data collection, research design, data analysis).

Major modifications can be regarding substantial changes to literature; substantial changes to structure; change to style of text (i.e., more critical or more academic); new data collection; need to change some aspects of the methodology used, revisions, change or refocus of the theoretical framework; clarification of research question (with fundamental change to structure of the thesis), etc.

The modifications should be made by the Student within a **maximum of twelve months**. The Student should discuss with the Supervisor and, if necessary, the Academic Director the feasibility of these major modifications within this timeframe.

Once the modifications are provided, the Student must resubmit the thesis to the Academic Director (copy the supervisor and the Programme Coordinator) with a letter to the Reviewers (see Section 7.9 description of the letter to the reviewers).

It is compulsory to provide a version of the Final Thesis in which the changes are highlighted because the letter to the Reviewers will detail the modifications and the changed page numbers.

The Reviewers restart the review process and have four weeks to evaluate the new version

of the Final Thesis. They may authorise (with minor modifications or without modifications) the defence or refuse it.

If both Reviewers decide that the Final Thesis is not acceptable, the Student can be judged to have failed. The Review Committee, acting in its academic role, will take appropriate action (see previous Section 7.5 Review Process: Rejection of the thesis).

NO, moderate to significant modifications

- ☐ c. Moderate to Significant modifications requested (1-6 months).
- ☐ d. Major modifications requested (6-12 months).
- Modifications to be completed within a period of minimum one month and maximum twelve months, or timeline defined by Academic Director.
- Student shall provide:
 - A point-by-point statement of responses to reviewer's comments;
 - A complete list of modifications; including page number(s) where modifications appear
 - A clean copy of the revised thesis.
- The modifications will be subject to a formal second review
 - Viva subject to satisfactory completion of modifications requested.
- Viva:
 - No date can be set for viva at this point. A date may be set following second formal review.

7.9. Letter to the Reviewers

In case of minor and/or major modifications, the Student must write a **letter to the Reviewers**, which is of major importance and should provide an answer for every comment raised in both reports.

The letter starts with a normal letter introduction and then details the modifications that have been made in response to the Reviewers' comments and the modifications' location in the Thesis. In case of disagreement with a comment, the Student must explain in detail why the comment does not apply to the research and provide a scientific explanation.

The letter to the Reviewer could include a table where each comment is addressed and follow a point-by-point statement structured as:

1. an exhaustive list of each Reviewer's comments (in column A);
2. the solutions/responses given to each of these Reviewer's comments (in column B); and
3. the page number where the updates have been made (in column C).

The comments from the External and Internal Reviewer can be addressed separately, if it is more convenient. As a general indication, a letter to the Reviewers takes four to fifteen pages at this level of study.

7.10. Appointment of an additional Reviewer

In case of split reviews between the Internal and External Reviewers after the submission of the revised thesis, the Academic Director can decide to appoint a third Reviewer upon advice from the Review Committee acting in its academic role.

Example: if after major revisions, one Reviewer authorises the defence but the other reviewer rejects the thesis, then a third reviewer can be appointed.

The third Reviewer evaluation will produce one of three possible outcomes:

- acceptance of the Viva voce;
- resubmission following minor or major revisions; or
- rejection

The third Reviewer will act as an arbiter in the final decision. Appointing a third Reviewer does disqualify neither the existing Reviewers nor their reviews. The Internal, External and their Reviewers will be invited to participate in the Viva. The only case in which a Reviewer may not participate in the final steps of the Viva is if they decide to withdraw from the process.

7.11. Setting a date for the viva voce

The Programme Coordinator is in charge of setting a date for the Viva. A date can be set only when two Reviewers authorise the defence. The Programme Coordinator will consult the Academic Director (chair of the Thesis committee), the two Reviewers, the Supervisor, and the Student to determine an appropriate date.

It is formally forbidden to set a date before all reports have been received or if a Reviewer requires significant or major modifications to the thesis.

7.12. Thesis oral defence (Viva voce)

The defence may be organised only if:

- (1) two Reviewers give permission to defend;
- (2) the Student is in good academic standing—including annual evaluation and seminar attendance; and
- (3) tuition fees have been paid in full.

The Student defends the thesis during an open-door Viva examination session with the Thesis Committee.

The Thesis Committee is fully responsible for assessing the doctoral quality of the Thesis. When they sign the Viva Joint Final Report, they attest to this responsibility.

The Thesis Committee includes:

- Compulsorily: the chairperson (Academic Director or faculty member) and the two initial Reviewers and a third Reviewer if one was appointed during the review process
- Optionally: the Student's Supervisor.

7.13. Viva protocol

The Viva protocol is the following:

1. The Chair of the Thesis Committee launches the Viva, introducing the Student and the Thesis Committee members;
2. The Student provides a 20-minute presentation. The Student may present the genesis of the question as an introduction; key gaps from the literature review; the research model, if relevant; the research methodology; the key results; the theoretical contributions; and the managerial implications;
3. The Chair invites the External Reviewer to proceed to question the Student;
4. Once the External Reviewer is satisfied with the Student's answers, the Chair invites the Internal Reviewer to proceed to question the Student;
5. The Supervisor's role is circumscribed to the period of supervision: once Internal and External Reviewers have been appointed by the Academic Director to review the Final Thesis, the Supervisor's role becomes a consultative one that remains neutral and non-decisional in nature. This role remains in place for both the review process and in the Viva itself. The Supervisor's role during the review process is to supervise and support the Student in their work to satisfy Reviewer requests for modifications.
6. If the Supervisor attends the Viva Voce, the Chair offers the Supervisor the opportunity to comment on the Thesis and the work performed by the Student. This usually occurs at the end of the Q&A session and its related discussion. The role of the Supervisor at the Viva is non-decisional and that of observer. The Supervisor does not participate in the deliberation of the jury, unless appointment by the Chair (but will remain available if the Thesis Committee requires any inputs should any questions arise during the deliberation);
7. The Chair may ask questions of the Student before the end of the Viva Voce;

8. Afterwards, the Student, Supervisor and any public observers must leave the room to allow the Thesis Committee to undertake confidential deliberations. The final decision to grant the degree will be determined and validated by the Thesis Committee. The Thesis Committee also may require modifications to the Final Thesis within a specified period of time, and the Internal Reviewer will be responsible for validating the revisions. If modifications are required, the Student's diploma will be granted after submitting the revised version and receiving confirmation from the Academic Director;
9. The Thesis Committee may put on their ceremonial gowns at this stage (this can also be done at the beginning, before the start of the viva, but it is not compulsory);
10. The Chair will invite the Student and the audience into the room;
11. The Thesis Committee, the Student, and the audience will stand to hear the results of the deliberation as stated by the Chair. If no modifications are required, the Student will be admitted immediately to the degree of Doctor of Business Administration; and
12. The Student may also put on a ceremonial gown and receive the diploma from the Chair or from the Supervisor.

In the event that a Reviewer cannot be present for the Viva itself, neither in person nor remotely, the Chair will request that he or she sends written questions in advance. Thereby, he or she can be represented *in absentia* at the viva. After the post-viva Joint Final Report draft is circulated with all, the absent member may add additional information and points already treated in the thesis review, for inclusion in the Student's Joint Final Report.

7.14. Online attendance

Given the solemnity of the event, the norm is the viva is organised in person on Grenoble Ecole de Management's premises. Under extraordinary circumstances, the Viva can be organised online. In this event, the Programme Coordinator will communicate connection details to the Student, the Supervisor and all Thesis Committee members.

In exceptional circumstances, one of the Thesis Committee may provide comments and questions *in absentia*, and the Chair of the Committee or a faculty member performing research in the same field will read the report and attest that the responses provided by the Student are satisfactory.

Annexe 1. Research Proposal Assessment Grid



ASSESSMENT

Research Proposal

(deliverable 1)

DBA programme

Grenoble Ecole de Management

Name of the Student:

Supervisor(s):

1- Syllabus deliverable 1: Research Proposal

Personal work	200 hours	Total Study Hours	200
Description	The Research Proposal (±2,000 words) must include - Topic - Knowledge claim - o Research question: One question ending on a question mark Research question triple motivation - o Personal motivation - o Professional motivation (why does this question bother practitioners?) - o Academic motivation (to what community?) - o Intuition of a possible answer to this question and where this intuition is coming from - Means of answering research question - o Needed empirical material - o Empirical material availability and accessibility - o Possible methodology for data collection (roughly, as per module in seminar 1) - Expected impact - o How can the thesis be pertinent to the practitioners interested in the question? - o How could the thesis be utilised by candidate in his or her work? Or how could the thesis help the candidate's professional development		
Learning Outcomes	After this deliverable, Students will have better defined their research project.		
Learning objectives	LO 1.1) Is capable of (re)defining and (re)stating a main research question LO 1.2) Is capable of justifying the research questions from both practical and theoretical perspectives LO 1.3) Has preliminary understanding about the main research designs available in business research LO 2.1) Has preliminary understandings of key theories relevant to the research topic L.O 2.2) Can articulate at a preliminary level the existing research gaps in the relevant literature LO 3.2) The document is written in a formal, academic style Yes/No LO 4) Is able to evaluate the issue associated with ethical practices in research and higher education (collaboration with other researchers, plagiarism...) Yes/No		
Teaching Method	Guidance from the Supervisor Participation in and attendance of the workshops		
Evaluation	Assessment by the Supervisor (Extended Research Proposal evaluation form) with written feedback provided to the Student		
Grade	Out of 20 (see page final page)		

2. Assessment by the Supervisor

This assessment is the first of The DBA Programme. It is important for Students to receive detailed feedback and guidance on their research advancement. Your Student will receive a copy of this evaluation.

The purpose of this assessment is to provide Students with meaningful feedback and guidance, the grades are indicative and will not be included in transcripts or other official documents.

Learning Goal 1: The DBA Student has acquired the working knowledge in research design and methods necessary to undertake independent scholarly research	Evaluation 0: Irrelevant or not assessable ; 1: Weak 2: Pass 3: Good 4: Excellent
LO 1.1) Is capable of (re)defining and (re)stating a main research question	
LO 1.2) Is capable of justifying the research questions from both practical and theoretical perspectives	
LO 1.3) Has preliminary understanding about the main research designs available in business research	
Learning Goal 2: The DBA Student has acquired a 'state of the art' understanding of theories and practices in his/her area of research	Evaluation 0: Irrelevant or not assessable ; 1: Weak 2: Pass 3: Good 4: Excellent
LO 2.1) Has preliminary understandings of key theories relevant to the research topic	
LO 2.2) Can articulate at a preliminary level the existing research gaps in the relevant literature	
Learning Goal 3: The DBA Thesis contributes to practitioner knowledge and/or academic research	Evaluation Yes/No
LO 3.2) The document is written in a formal, academic style	
Learning Goal 4: The DBA Student's work reflects understanding or knowledge of ethical practices in research (collaboration, plagiarism, authorship, data integrity, confidentiality, data privacy)	Evaluation Evaluation Yes/No
LO 4) Is able to evaluate the issue associated with ethical practices in research and higher education (collaboration with other researchers, plagiarism...)	

Key strengths	
Key weaknesses	
Advice given to the student	

<i>Grade</i>	<i>/20</i>
--------------	------------

Date, signature of the Supervisor(s)



ASSESSMENT

Literature Review

(deliverable 2)

DBA programme

Grenoble Ecole de Management

Name of the Student:

Supervisor(s):

1- Syllabus deliverable 2: Literature Review

Personal work	200 hours	Total Study Hours	200
Description	The literature review ($\pm 10,000$ words) provides a critical and structured analysis of scientific knowledge in the pertinent research field. This written document should highlight existing research gaps and must be accompanied by a bibliography (Harvard or APA style). This literature review will be updated all along the DBA journey, but this first milestone helps the Student deepen knowledge in his or her research area. It is the continuity of the first deliverable, i.e., the research proposal. As such, it should cover: - Key constructs definitions - State of the art of the literature and addressed community What the main streams of thought on the topic are and how they position themselves vis-à-vis each other - On what do researchers agree or disagree in relation to the topic? - Gap in the literature: academic motivation for the thesis What is known and what needs knowing on the topic? - Justified and well-designed theoretical framework (quals) /or hypotheses (quants)		
Learning Outcomes	After this Deliverable, Students will have a better understanding of the contributions in their research field.		
Learning Goals	LO 1.1) Is capable of (re)defining and (re)stating a main research question LO 1.4) The document explicitly presents a research gap and a research question LO 2.3) The document reveals the understanding of existing academic knowledge, theories and debates on the topic LO 2.4) Is capable of adequately reviewing theories applicable to the organizational issue LO 2.5) The document reveals the ability to integrate existing academic knowledge and theories into a doctoral project LO 3.2) The document is written in a formal, academic style LO 4) Is able to evaluate the issue associated with ethical practices in research and higher education (collaboration with other researchers, plagiarism...)		
Teaching Method	Guidance from the supervisor Participation in and attendance of the workshops		
Evaluation	Assessment by the Supervisor (Literature Review evaluation form) with written feedback provided to the Student		
Grade	Out of 20 (see page final page)		

2- Assessment by the Supervisor

This assessment is the second of the DBA program. It is important for Students to receive feedback and guidance on their research advancement. Your Student will receive a copy of this evaluation.

The purpose of this assessment is to provide Students with meaningful feedback and guidance, the grades are indicative and will not be included in transcripts or other official documents.

Learning Goal 1: The DBA Student has acquired the working knowledge in research design and methods necessary to undertake independent scholarly research	Evaluation 0: Irrelevant or not assessable ; 1: Weak 2: Pass 3: Good 4: Excellent
LO 1.1) Is capable of (re)defining and (re)stating a main research question	
LO 1.4) The document explicitly presents a research gap and a research question	
Learning Goal 2: The DBA Student has acquired a 'state of the art' understanding of theories and practices in his/her area of research	Evaluation 0: Irrelevant or not assessable ; 1: Weak 2: Pass 3: Good 4: Excellent
LO 2.3) The document reveals the understanding of existing academic knowledge, theories and debates on the topic	
LO 2.4) Is capable of adequately reviewing theories applicable to the organizational issue	
LO 2.5) The document reveals the ability to integrate existing academic knowledge and theories into a doctoral project	
Learning Goal 3: The DBA Thesis contributes to practitioner knowledge and/or academic research	Evaluation Yes/No
LO 3.2) The document is written in a formal, academic style	
Learning Goal 4: The DBA Student's work reflects understanding or knowledge of ethical practices in research (collaboration, plagiarism, authorship, data integrity, confidentiality, data privacy)	Evaluation Evaluation Yes/No
LO 4) Is able to evaluate the issue associated with ethical practices in research and higher education (collaboration with other researchers, plagiarism...)	

Key strengths	
Key weaknesses	
Advice given to the student	

<i>Grade</i>	<i>/20</i>
--------------	------------

Date, signature of the Supervisor(s)



ASSESSMENT

Dissertation Proposal

(deliverable 3)

DBA programme

Grenoble Ecole de Management

Name of the Student:

1. Syllabus deliverable 3: Dissertation Proposal

Personal work	200 hours	Total Study Hours	200
Description	The Dissertation Proposal ($\pm 15,000$ words) must include: - Introduction - Research background - Research questions In case of paper-based thesis, the document must specify the research question of each paper. - Structure of the document - Personal/professional ties with the topic $\pm 1,000$ words Why are you personally interested in this topic? - Literature review ($\pm 10,000$) - Detailed research design with emphasis on data collection instruments and their justification, data collection, evidence of actual access to data, data analysis strategy ($\pm 3,500$ words) <i>Letter, emails, confirmation, authorisations, etc. (annex to the dissertation proposal)</i> <i>potential difficulties in setting up research design</i> <i>find a model article to follow</i> In case of paper-based thesis, the Student must also provide a plan of the three papers he or she is planning to write: type, targeted outlet, a brief outline of each paper. The student must show the progress made on the papers and include this into the Dissertation Proposal. In case a paper is already written, it must be added to the document. At least, one of the three papers must be ready for first presentation.		
Learning Outcomes	After this deliverable, Students will have better defined their research project.		
Learning objectives	LO 1.5) The empirical study is feasible (data accessibility, data collection calendar, student methodological skills) LO 1.6) Is able to choose methods aligned with the research question and theoretical framework LO 2.6) Is able to justify the articulating of a theoretical framework derived from the literature and consistent with the research question LO 3.1) Is capable of writing an original, rigorous and relevant piece of research on its own (research paper, doctoral thesis...) according to academic standards LO 3.2) The document is written in a formal, academic style Yes/No LO 4) Is able to evaluate the issue associated with ethical practices in research and higher education (collaboration with other researchers, plagiarism...) Yes/No LO 5.1) Is able to justify that the thesis is timely, pertinent and potentially impactful for organizations, management or society		
Teaching Method	Guidance from the Supervisor Participation in and attendance of the workshops		
Evaluation	Assessment by the Supervisor (Extended Research Proposal evaluation form) with written feedback provided to the Student		
Grade	Out of 20 (see page final page)		

2. Assessment by the Supervisor

Evaluation:

0: Irrelevant or not assessable

1: Weak

2: Pass

3: Good

4: Excellent

Learning Goal 1: The DBA Student has acquired the working knowledge in research design and methods necessary to undertake independent scholarly research	Evaluation 0-4
LO 1.5) The empirical study is feasible (data accessibility, data collection calendar, student methodological skills)	
LO 1.6) Is able to choose methods aligned with the research question and theoretical framework	
Learning Goal 2: The DBA Student has acquired a 'state of the art' understanding of theories and practices in his/her area of research	Evaluation 0-4
LO 2.6) Is able to justify the articulating of a theoretical framework derived from the literature and consistent with the research question	
Learning Goal 3: The DBA Thesis contributes to practitioner knowledge and/or academic research	Evaluation 0-4
LO 3.1) Is capable of writing an original, rigorous and relevant piece of research on its own (research paper, doctoral thesis...) according to academic standards	
Learning Goal 5: The DBA Student's work proposes practical solutions to significant organizational or societal issues, and grounds these solutions in current research and theory	Evaluation 0-4
LO 5.1) Is able to justify that the thesis is timely, pertinent and potentially impactful for organizations, management or society	
Learning Goal 3: The DBA Thesis contributes to practitioner knowledge and/or academic research	Evaluation Yes/No
LO 3.2) The document is written in a formal, academic style	
Learning Goal 4: The DBA Student's work reflects understanding or knowledge of ethical practices in research (collaboration, plagiarism, authorship, data integrity, confidentiality, data privacy)	Evaluation Yes/No
LO 4) Is able to evaluate the issue associated with ethical practices in research and higher education (collaboration with other researchers, plagiarism...)	

Key strengths	
Key weaknesses	
Advice given to the Student	

<i>Grade</i>	<i>/20</i>
--------------	------------

3. Final recommendation

Do you recommend admitting the DBA Student in Phase 2 of The DBA Programme?

Yes, definitely	
Yes, under conditions (precise the conditions)	
No, (summarise the reasons)	

Date, signature of the Supervisor:



ASSESSMENT

Dissertation Proposal

(deliverable 3)

DBA programme

Grenoble Ecole de Management

Name of the Student:

Title of the document:

1. Syllabus deliverable 3: Dissertation Proposal

Personal work	200 hours	Total Study Hours	200
Description	The Dissertation Proposal ($\pm 15,000$ words) must include: - Introduction - Research background - Research questions In case of paper-based thesis, the document must specify the research question of each paper. - Structure of the document - Personal/professional ties with the topic $\pm 1,000$ words Why are you personally interested in this topic? - Literature review ($\pm 10,000$) - Detailed research design with emphasis on data collection instruments and their justification, data collection, evidence of actual access to data, data analysis strategy ($\pm 3,500$ words) <i>Letter, emails, confirmation, authorisations, etc. (annex to the dissertation proposal)</i> <i>potential difficulties in setting up research design, find a model article to follow</i> In case of paper-based thesis, the Student must also provide a plan of the three papers he or she is planning to write: type, targeted outlet, a brief outline of each paper. The student must show the progress made on the papers and include this into the Dissertation Proposal. In case a paper is already written, it must be added to the document. At least, one of the three papers must be ready for first presentation.		
Learning Outcomes	After this deliverable, Students will have better defined their research project.		
Learning objectives	LO 1.1) Is capable of (re)defining and (re)stating a main research question LO 1.3) Has preliminary understanding about the main research designs available in business research LO 1.5) The empirical study is feasible (data accessibility, data collection calendar, student methodological skills) LO 1.6) Is able to choose methods aligned with the research question and theoretical framework LO 2.1) Has preliminary understandings of key theories relevant to the research topic LO 2.2) Can articulate at a preliminary level the existing research gaps in the relevant literature LO 2.3) The document reveals the understanding of existing academic knowledge, theories and debates on the topic LO 2.4) Is capable of adequately reviewing theories applicable to the organizational issue LO 2.5) The document reveals the ability to integrate existing academic knowledge and theories into a doctoral project LO 2.6) Is able to justify the articulating of a theoretical framework derived from the literature and consistent with the research question LO 3.1) Is capable of writing an original, rigorous and relevant piece of research on its own (research paper, doctoral thesis...) according to academic standards LO 3.2) The document is written in a formal, academic style Yes/No LO 4) Is able to evaluate the issue associated with ethical practices in research and higher education (collaboration with other researchers, plagiarism...) Yes/No LO 5.1) Is able to justify that the thesis is timely, pertinent and potentially impactful for organizations, management or society		

Teaching Method	Guidance from the Supervisor Participation in and attendance of the seminars
Evaluation	Assessment by the Supervisor (Extended Research Proposal evaluation form) with written feedback provided to the Student
Grade	Out of 40 (see final page)

2. Feedback from the Reviewers

Evaluation:
 0: Irrelevant or not assessable
 1: Weak
 2: Pass
 3: Good
 4: Excellent

Learning Goal 1: The DBA Student has acquired the working knowledge in research design and methods necessary to undertake independent scholarly research	Evaluation 0-4
LO 1.1) Is capable of (re)defining and (re)stating a main research question	
LO 1.3) Has preliminary understanding about the main research designs available in business research	
LO 1.5) The empirical study is feasible (data accessibility, data collection calendar, student methodological skills)	
LO 1.6) Is able to choose methods aligned with the research question and theoretical framework	
Learning Goal 2: The DBA Student has acquired a 'state of the art' understanding of theories and practices in his/her area of research	Evaluation 0-4
LO 2.1) Has preliminary understandings of key theories relevant to the research topic	
LO 2.2) Can articulate at a preliminary level the existing research gaps in the relevant literature	
LO 2.3) The document reveals the understanding of existing academic knowledge, theories and debates on the topic	
LO 2.4) Is capable of adequately reviewing theories applicable to the organizational issue	
LO 2.5) The document reveals the ability to integrate existing academic knowledge and theories into a doctoral project	
LO 2.6) Is able to justify the articulating of a theoretical framework derived from the literature and consistent with the research question	
Learning Goal 3: The DBA Thesis contributes to practitioner knowledge and/or academic research	Evaluation Yes/No
LO 3.1) Is capable of writing an original, rigorous and relevant piece of research on its own (research paper, doctoral thesis...) according to academic standards	
LO 3.2) The document is written in a formal, academic style	
Learning Goal 4: The DBA Student's work reflects understanding or knowledge of ethical practices in research (collaboration, plagiarism, authorship, data integrity, confidentiality, data privacy)	Evaluation Yes/No
LO 4) Is able to evaluate the issue associated with ethical practices in research and higher education (collaboration with other researchers, plagiarism...)	
Learning Goal 5: The DBA Student's work proposes practical solutions to significant organisational or societal issues, and grounds these solutions in current research and theory	Evaluation Yes/No
LO 5.1) Is able to justify that the thesis is timely, pertinent and potentially impactful for organisations, management or society	

The feedback for the Student is given to the student and written by Reviewers using the present form.

*Using the below table, please give your feedback on the **main strengths** of this work. For example, which aspects of this study should be encouraged, maintained, or continued? What are the positive aspects of the work conducted thus far?*

*Likewise, using the table below, please provide details on the **main areas of improvement** which would further enhance the study. For example, which aspects of this study could be revised, corrected, or reconsidered? What are your recommendations in terms of remedial actions to enhance the overall quality?*

Key strengths	
Key weaknesses	
Advice given to the Student	

Grade	/40
-------	-----

3. Final recommendation

Do you recommend admitting the DBA Student in Phase 2 of The DBA Programme?

<i>Response</i>	<i>Comments</i>
Yes, definitely	
Yes, under specific conditions (please specify conditions)	
No (please specify the reasons and provide detail on the reasons)	

Date, signatures of the Reviewers



ASSESSMENT

Final Thesis

DBA programme

Grenoble Ecole de Management

Name of the Student:

Supervisor(s):

Title of thesis:

1. Syllabus deliverable 1: Final thesis

Personal work	200 hours	Total Study Hours	200
Description	- ±45,000 words (max 50,000 words) - Updated Dissertation Proposal ±15,000 words - Methodology ±4,000 words - Main empirical study and results (depends on methods) up to ±15,000 words - Answer to the research question and discussion ±11,000 words - o How does the thesis contribute to academic debates? ±3,000 words - o Impact report: How can society, companies and practitioners benefit from this thesis? ±5,000 words - o How can this thesis serve the candidate's future? ±3,000 words		
Learning Outcomes	After this deliverable, students will qualify for the partial fulfilment of the Doctorate of Business Administration and be allowed to proceed to Viva Voce.		
Learning objectives	LO 1.1) Is capable of (re)defining and (re)stating a main research question LO 1.2) Is capable of justifying the research questions from both practical and theoretical perspectives LO 1.4) The document explicitly presents a research gap and a research question LO 1.5) The empirical study is feasible (data accessibility, data collection calendar, student methodological skills) LO 1.6) Is able to choose methods aligned with the research question and theoretical framework LO 1.7) Is able to adequately perform the data analyses techniques relevant to his/her research LO 2.3) The document reveals the understanding of existing academic knowledge, theories, and debates on the topic LO 2.4) Is capable of adequately reviewing theories applicable to the organizational issue LO 2.5) The document reveals the ability to integrate existing academic knowledge and theories into a doctoral project LO 2.6) Is able to justify the articulating of a theoretical framework derived from the literature and consistent with the research question LO 3.1) Is capable of writing an original, rigorous, and relevant piece of research on its own (research paper, doctoral thesis...) according to academic standards LO 3.2) The document is written in a formal, academic style LO 3.4) Is able to discuss academic implications and limitations of his or her research LO 4) Is able to evaluate the issue associated with ethical practices in research and higher education (collaboration with other researchers, plagiarism...) LO 5.1) Is able to justify that the thesis is timely, pertinent and potentially impactful for organizations, management or society LO 5.2) Is capable of adequately reviewing theories that could be applied to the organizational issue LO 5.3) Is able to propose solution(s) based upon his or her ability to combine theory and practice LO 5.4) Is able to anticipate the possible use that could be made of his or her research		
Teaching Method	Guidance from the supervisor, Participation in and attendance of the workshops		
Evaluation	Assessment by the supervisor (Extended Research Proposal evaluation form) with written feedback provided to the Students		

Note on Paper-based theses

DBA theses at Grenoble Ecole de Management can be *paper-based*, meaning that they integrate articles that are either published or at the publishable level. Generally,

1. the thesis should include three distinct papers;
2. at least one out of the three papers should be **empirical in nature** (i.e. it presents data from the student's original data collection and data analysis) and deemed publishable in an academic journal
3. the 2 other papers should be published or accepted for publication
4. the papers may be coauthored, but the DBA student should be *first author* on at least two of the three papers; and

The structure of the paper-based thesis should present:

7. an abstract that specifies the research background, research objectives, methodology, and key findings (according to format in thesis guidelines);
8. an acknowledgments page;
9. an introductory chapter of 3,500 words minimum that explains the subject and the research question(s) of each paper and presents the state-of-the-art literature not included in the articles but necessary to the comprehension of the overall thesis. It also details the linkages between the three articles and presents the overall coherence of the document;
- 10 a chapter on the Overall Research Design & Methodology that is used to answer the research questions of the papers;
- 11 the three articles themselves, each preceded by an *explanatory note* that details how the article makes a contribution to research or to practice by presenting each article's target publication outlet and its 'lifecycle'
12. a *general conclusion* of 3,500 words minimum including the main theoretical contributions, limits of the research, and recommendations for future research.

The table below provides the deliverables for Phase 2 I case of a paper-based Thesis

Up to two of the listed deliverables (publication or attendance) is REQUIRED in addition to ONE publishable academic paper

	Examples	Proof Required	Additional Comments
1. Peer-reviewed conference paper presentation	Paper presented at annual Academy of Management conference or another highly recognized academic conference (for validation, please inform the program director, who will seek validation by the Review Committee)	Conference program with your name and session-specific information (name of session, conveners, date of presentation, etc.).	You may subsequently publish the proceedings or publish this conference paper, but the publication of your conference paper <i>cannot count as either deliverable 2 or 3</i> because it is the same paper and not a freestanding paper significantly different than the presentation at the conference.
2. Chapter published in a book	Chapter published/accepted for publication in a collective work on your thesis topic in the management discipline	Publication acceptance receipt from publisher/lead editor(s) of the work, acceptance notification of your chapter for a call for papers on a given topic, ISBN number, URL link to article online, or other form of proof	It is best to work with editors at well-circulated publishing houses (Routledge, Sage, university presses, etc.) to be sure that your work will be listed and well-referenced online and in research databases.
3. Article published in a managerial review or practitioner journal	Article accepted for publication in a recognized practitioner-oriented journal, such as <i>California Management Review</i> , <i>Engaged Management Review</i> , <i>Business and Management Horizons</i> , <i>Harvard Business Review</i> , <i>Sloan Management Review</i> , or any other well-recognized industry-specific publication	Publication acceptance receipt from manuscript central/journal editors of your manuscript, publication acceptance notification of your article for a call for papers on a given topic, ISBN number, URL link to article online, or other form of proof	Managerial and sector- and industry-specific publications and other specialized journals can be an excellent way to get your research pipeline started and give yourself some visibility. You must check with your supervisor and program director when making a choice on the suitability of a managerial or practitioner-oriented publication.
4. Full-length case study based on your data collection	A full-length case study based on data collected in an empirical field of study/site that should in some way be included in the case (statistical evidence, excerpts/quotes from key informants/interviewees, etc.). A teaching note should accompany the case submitted to, for example, the Case Center at Cranfield University, Ivey Case Publishing, or Harvard Business Publishing, etc.	Publication acceptance receipt from case study publishing editor(s), publication acceptance notification of case, proof of submission, and entry of case in an annual case study <i>competition</i> (Case Centre, Ivey, EFMD, etc.).	If using the case study methodology for your project, follow the format for cases used in business school teaching. Various schools and organizations, such as the Case Centre, Ivey Business School Publishing, have their own guidelines for full-length cases; therefore, you should decide with your supervisor and program director which publication outlet to target your case.
5. Practitioner conference paper presentation	Paper presented at a practitioner conference such as Harvard-affiliated Institute of Coaching annual conference, etc.	Conference program with your name and session-specific information (name of session, conveners, date of presentation, etc.).	You may subsequently publish the proceedings or publish this conference paper, but the publication of your conference paper <i>cannot count as either deliverable 2 or 3</i> because it is the same paper and not a freestanding paper significantly different than the presentation at the conference.
6. Institutional working paper	White papers or reports endorsed by institutions such as the World Bank, IMF, the European Commission, etc.	Publication acceptance or notification receipt	

For the academic paper in particular:

- The targeted journal must be explicitly specified including its rank in the ABS journal list;
- The Supervisor as co-author guarantees that the paper is ready for submission.
- In case the paper has already been submitted to a journal the Student provides evidence from the editor's office that it was not desk-rejected.
-

Once the required level for the submitted papers has been established, the complete thesis will be examined by the Jury, and the usual process of defense as detailed in the Stage 2 Guide is followed.

Articles published before graduation must show the student's affiliation to Grenoble Ecole de Management as a DBA student or candidate. Articles published after graduation should acknowledge Grenoble Ecole de Management.

Because it is expected the supervisor(s) have provided the guidance and support necessary to submit papers to ranked peer-reviewed journals, students are advised to include their supervisor(s) as coauthors for the papers submitted.

If the same research data is used in two or more articles, it is necessary to transparently employ substantially different theoretical approaches and analyses and to inform the journals, the readers, and all stakeholders of this. It has become a common practice in academia to share data, and the Doctoral School strongly recommends sharing those data with reviewers and/or journals.

2. Assessment by the Supervisor

Learning Goal 1: The DBA Student has acquired the working knowledge in research design and methods necessary to undertake independent scholarly research

	Below expectations	At expectations	Above expectations
LO 1.1) Is capable of (re)defining and (re)stating a main research question			
LO 1.2) Is capable of justifying the research questions from both practical and theoretical perspectives			
LO 1.4) The document explicitly presents a research gap and a research question			
LO 1.6) Is able to choose methods aligned with the research question and theoretical framework			
LO 1.7) Is able to adequately perform the data analyses techniques relevant to his/her research			

Comments

...

Learning Goal 2: The DBA Student has acquired a 'state of the art' understanding of theories and practices in his/her area of research

	Below expectations	At expectations	Above expectations
LO 2.3) The document reveals the understanding of existing academic knowledge, theories and debates on the topic			
LO 2.4) Is capable of adequately reviewing theories applicable to the organisational issue			
LO 2.5) The document reveals the ability to integrate existing academic knowledge and theories into a doctoral project			
LO 2.6) Is able to justify the articulating of a theoretical framework derived from the literature and consistent with the research question			

Comments

...

Learning Goal 3: The DBA Thesis contributes to practitioner knowledge and/or academic research

	Below expectations	At expectations	Above expectations
LO 3.1) Is capable of writing an original, rigorous, and relevant piece of research on its own (research paper, doctoral thesis...) according to academic standards			
LO 3.2) The document is written in a formal, academic style			
LO 3.4) Is able to discuss academic implications and limitations of his/her research			

Learning Goal 4: The DBA Student's work reflects understanding or knowledge of ethical practices in research (collaboration, plagiarism, authorship, data integrity, confidentiality, data privacy)

	Below expectations	At expectations	Above expectations
LO 4) Is able to evaluate the issue associated with ethical practices in research and higher education (collaboration with other researchers, plagiarism...) Yes/No			

Comments

...

Learning Goal 5: The DBA Students's work proposes practical solutions to significant organisational or societal issues, and grounds these solutions in current research and theory

	Below expectations	At expectations	Above expectations
LO 5.1) Is able to justify that the thesis is timely, pertinent, and potentially impactful for organisations, management, or society			
LO 5.2) Is capable of adequately reviewing theories that could be applied to the organisational issue			
LO 5.3) Is able to propose solution(s) based upon his or her ability to combine theory and practice			
LO 5.4) Is able to anticipate the possible use that could be made of his or her research			

Comments

...

3. Final recommendation

Do you recommend admitting the DBA Student in Phase 2 of The DBA Programme?

Yes, definitely	
Yes, under conditions (specify conditions)	
No, (summarise reasons)	

Date, signature of the Supervisor(s):

Annex 4b. Final Thesis Preliminary Report (Reviewers)



Doctorate in Business Administration (DBA) Programme

PRELIMINARY REPORT OF REVIEWER

GRENOBLE ECOLE DE MANAGEMENT – DOCTORAL SCHOOL

Name of Student:

Title of Thesis:.....

Name of Reviewer:

Reviewers should independently complete the thesis evaluation and write a preliminary report which will indicate their provisional assessment of the thesis and of the issues to be explored in the Viva.

1. Syllabus deliverable 4: Final Thesis

Personal work	200 hours	Total Study Hours	200
Description	±45,000 words (max 50,000 words) - Updated Dissertation Proposal ±15,000 words - Methodology ±4,000 words - Main empirical study and results (depends on methods) up to ±15,000 words - Answer to the research question and discussion ±11,000 words - o How does the thesis contribute to academic debates? ±3,000 words - o Impact report: How can society, companies and practitioners benefit from this thesis? ±5,000 words - o How can this thesis serve the candidate's future? ±3,000 words		
Learning Outcomes	After this deliverable, Students will qualify for the partial fulfilment of the Doctorate of Business Administration and be allowed to proceed to viva voce.		
Learning objectives	LO 1.1) Is capable of (re)defining and (re)stating a main research question LO 1.2) Is capable of justifying the research questions from both practical and theoretical perspectives LO 1.4) The document explicitly presents a research gap and a research question LO 1.5) The empirical study is feasible (data accessibility, data collection calendar, student methodological skills) LO 1.6) Is able to choose methods aligned with the research question and theoretical framework LO 1.7) Is able to adequately perform the data analyses techniques relevant to his/her research LO 2.3) The document reveals the understanding of existing academic knowledge, theories, and debates on the topic LO 2.4) Is capable of adequately reviewing theories applicable to the organizational issue LO 2.5) The document reveals the ability to integrate existing academic knowledge and theories into a doctoral project LO 2.6) Is able to justify the articulating of a theoretical framework derived from the literature and consistent with the research question LO 3.1) Is capable of writing an original, rigorous, and relevant piece of research on its own (research paper, doctoral thesis...) according to academic standards LO 3.2) The document is written in a formal, academic style LO 3.3) Research findings can be disseminated through appropriate communication channels (peer-reviewed journal, peer-reviewed conference, professional conference, book...) LO 3.4) Is able to discuss academic implications and limitations of his or her research LO 4) Is able to evaluate the issue associated with ethical practices in research and higher education (collaboration with other researchers, plagiarism...) LO 5.1) Is able to justify that the thesis is timely, pertinent and potentially impactful for organizations, management or society LO 5.2) Is capable of adequately reviewing theories that could be applied to the organizational issue LO 5.3) Is able to propose solution(s) based upon his or her ability to combine theory and practice LO 5.4) Is able to anticipate the possible use that could be made of his or her research		
Teaching Method	Guidance from the supervisor, Participation in and attendance of the workshops		

Note on Paper-based theses

DBA theses at Grenoble Ecole de Management can be *paper-based*, meaning that they integrate articles that are either published or at the publishable level. Generally,

1. the thesis should include three distinct papers;
2. at least one out of the three papers should be **empirical in nature** (i.e. it presents data from the student's original data collection and data analysis) and deemed publishable in an academic journal
3. the 2 other papers should be published or accepted for publication
4. the papers may be coauthored, but the DBA Student should be *first author* on at least two of the three papers; and

The structure of the paper-based thesis should present:

- an abstract that specifies the research background, research objectives, methodology, and key findings (according to format in thesis guidelines);
- an acknowledgments page;
- an introductory chapter of 3,500 words minimum that explains the subject and the research question(s) of each paper and presents the state-of-the-art literature not included in the articles but necessary to the comprehension of the overall thesis. It also details the linkages between the three articles and presents the overall coherence of the document;
- a chapter on the *Overall Research Design & Methodology* that is used to answer the research questions of the papers;
- the three articles themselves, each preceded by an *explanatory note* that details how the article makes a contribution to research or to practice by presenting each article's target publication outlet and its 'lifecycle';
- a general conclusion of 3,500 words minimum including the main theoretical contributions, limits of the research, and recommendations for future research.

The table below provides the deliverables for Phase 2 I case of a paper-based thesis

Up to two of the listed deliverables (publication or attendance) is REQUIRED in addition to ONE publishable academic paper

Examples		Proof Required	Additional Comments
1. Peer-reviewed conference paper presentation	Paper presented at annual Academy of Management conference or another highly recognized academic conference (for validation, please inform the program director, who will seek validation by the Review Committee)	Conference program with your name and session-specific information (name of session, conveners, date of presentation, etc.).	You may subsequently publish the proceedings or publish this conference paper, but the publication of your conference paper <i>cannot count as either deliverable 2 or 3</i> because it is the same paper and not a freestanding paper significantly different than the presentation at the conference.
2. Chapter published in a book	Chapter published/accepted for publication in a collective work on your thesis topic in the management discipline	Publication acceptance receipt from publisher/lead editor(s) of the work, acceptance notification of your chapter for a call for papers on a given topic, ISBN number, URL link to article online, or other form of proof	It is best to work with editors at well-circulated publishing houses (Routledge, Sage, university presses, etc.) to be sure that your work will be listed and well-referenced online and in research databases.
3. Article published in a managerial review or practitioner journal	Article accepted for publication in a recognized practitioner-oriented journal, such as <i>California Management Review</i> , <i>Engaged Management Review</i> , <i>Business and Management Horizons</i> , <i>Harvard Business Review</i> , <i>Sloan Management Review</i> , or any other well-recognized industry-specific publication	Publication acceptance receipt from manuscript central/journal editors of your manuscript, publication acceptance notification of your article for a call for papers on a given topic, ISBN number, URL link to article online, or other form of proof	Managerial and sector- and industry-specific publications and other specialized journals can be an excellent way to get your research pipeline started and give yourself some visibility. You must check with your supervisor and program director when making a choice on the suitability of a managerial or practitioner-oriented publication.
4. Full-length case study based on your data collection	A full-length case study based on data collected in an empirical field of study/site that should in some way be included in the case (statistical evidence, excerpts/quotes from key informants/interviewees, etc.). A teaching note should accompany the case submitted to, for example, the Case Center at Cranfield University, Ivey Case Publishing, or Harvard Business Publishing, etc.	Publication acceptance receipt from case study publishing editor(s), publication acceptance notification of case, proof of submission, and entry of case in an annual case study <i>competition</i> (Case Centre, Ivey, EFMD, etc.).	If using the case study methodology for your project, follow the format for cases used in business school teaching. Various schools and organizations, such as the Case Centre, Ivey Business School Publishing, have their own guidelines for full-length cases; therefore, you should decide with your supervisor and program director which publication outlet to target your case.
5. Practitioner conference paper presentation	Paper presented at a practitioner conference such as Harvard-affiliated Institute of Coaching annual conference, etc.	Conference program with your name and session-specific information (name of session, conveners, date of presentation, etc.).	You may subsequently publish the proceedings or publish this conference paper, but the publication of your conference paper <i>cannot count as either deliverable 2 or 3</i> because it is the same paper and not a freestanding paper significantly different than the presentation at the conference.
6. Institutional working paper	White papers or reports endorsed by institutions such as the World Bank, IMF, the European Commission, etc.	Publication acceptance or notification receipt	

For the academic paper in particular:

- The targeted journal must be explicitly specified including its rank in the ABS journal list;
- The Supervisor as co-author guarantees that the paper is ready for submission.
- In case the paper has already been submitted to a journal the Student provides evidence from the editor's office that it was not desk-rejected.

Once the required level for the submitted papers has been established, the complete thesis will be examined by the Jury, and the usual process of defense as detailed in the Stage 2 Guide is followed.

Articles published before graduation must show the student's affiliation to Grenoble Ecole de Management as a DBA student or candidate. Articles published after graduation should acknowledge Grenoble Ecole de Management.

Because it is expected the Supervisor(s) have provided the guidance and support necessary to submit papers to ranked peer-reviewed journals, Students are advised to include their Supervisor(s) as co-authors for the papers submitted.

If the same research data is used in two or more articles, it is necessary to transparently employ substantially different theoretical approaches and analyses and to inform the journals, the readers, and all stakeholders of this. It has become a common practice in academia to share data, and the Doctoral School strongly recommends sharing those data with reviewers and/or journals.

2. Thesis evaluation

Learning Goal 1: The DBA Student has acquired the working knowledge in research design and methods necessary to undertake independent scholarly research

	Below expectations	At expectations	Above expectations
LO 1.1) Is capable of (re)defining and (re)stating a main research question			
LO 1.2) Is capable of justifying the research questions from both practical and theoretical perspectives			
LO 1.4) The document explicitly presents a research gap and a research question			
LO 1.6) Is able to choose methods aligned with the research question and theoretical framework			
LO 1.7) Is able to adequately perform the data analyses techniques relevant to his/her research			

Learning Goal 2: The DBA student has acquired a ‘state of the art’ understanding of theories and practices in his/her area of research

	Below expectations	At expectations	Above expectations
LO 2.3) The document reveals the understanding of existing academic knowledge, theories, and debates on the topic			
LO 2.4) Is capable of adequately reviewing theories applicable to the organizational issue			
LO 2.5) The document reveals the ability to integrate existing academic knowledge and theories into a doctoral project			
LO 2.6) Is able to justify the articulating of a theoretical framework derived from the literature and consistent with the research question			

Learning Goal 3: The DBA Thesis contributes to practitioner knowledge and/or academic research

	Below expectations	At expectations	Above expectations
LO 3.1) Is capable of writing an original, rigorous, and relevant piece of research on its own (research paper, doctoral thesis...) according to academic standards			
LO 3.2) The document is written in a formal, academic style			
LO 3.3) Research findings can be disseminated through appropriate communication channels (peer-reviewed journal, peer-reviewed conference, professional conference, book...)			
LO 3.4) Is able to discuss academic implications and limitations of his/her research			

Learning Goal 4: The DBA Student's work reflects understanding or knowledge of ethical practices in research (collaboration, plagiarism, authorship, data integrity, confidentiality, data privacy)

	Below expectations	At expectations	Above expectations
LO 4) Is able to evaluate the issue associated with ethical practices in research and higher education (collaboration with other researchers, plagiarism...)			

Learning Goal 5: The DBA Student's work proposes practical solutions to significant organisational or societal issues, and grounds these solutions in current research and theory

	Below expectations	At expectations	Above expectations
LO 5.1) Is able to justify that the thesis is timely, pertinent, and potentially impactful for organisations, management, or society			
LO 5.2) Is capable of adequately reviewing theories that could be applied to the organisational issue			
LO 5.3) Is able to propose solution(s) based upon his or her ability to combine theory and practice			
LO 5.4) Is able to anticipate the possible use that could be made of his or her research			

Any additional comments on the following areas: organisation; structure; presentation; authenticity; content; publishable quality and critical awareness of subject.

...

1) Areas for discussion in the oral examination

...

2) Based on your evaluation of the thesis, do you agree that the Final Thesis is of the required standard and that the Student can defend their DBA Thesis?

(Please tick the appropriate box).

YES

- ☐ a. Proceed to viva with **no modifications**
- ☐ b. Authorization to defend providing **minor modifications*** with resubmission of final thesis two weeks prior the viva voce. No additional formal review required.

NO

- ☐ c. **Moderate to Significant modifications**** requested (1-6 months). Student will prepare a modifications table to facilitate new review.
- ☐ d. **Major modifications***** requested (6-12 months). Student will prepare a modifications table to facilitate new review.

** Yes, **minor modifications**: **Minor** modifications may, for example, require changes in formatting, title, abstract, the addition of supplemental literature and references, alignment with APA style referencing & bibliography, minor expansion of managerial implication chapter, clarification of methods, etc. The minor modifications should be possible to complete within one month to three months. The candidate must provide the new version of the thesis and a letter to the reviewers at least two weeks before the viva voce. The reviewers do not formally review the new modified thesis.*

***No, **moderate to significant modifications**: **Moderate** modifications may include all the above but require a greater extent of re-framing or positioning. For example, changes may be required for the formulation of the research question, refinement of the gap addressed, the presentation of findings to align with standard practices, the discussion, methodological descriptions, a refocusing of the theoretical model or framework, or more substantial work on the managerial implications. These modifications are not significant enough to require a thorough re-organization but do require some re-thinking and re-positioning of the central arguments and contribution of the thesis. They can require anywhere from 1 to 6 months. Once the modifications are provided, the candidate must resubmit the thesis with a modifications table & letter to the reviewers to facilitate new review. The reviewers perform a new review and have four to six weeks to evaluate the new version of the thesis.*

***Significant** modifications mean that the thesis is close to the required level for doctoral work, but still may require substantive changes to, among other: the literature review; thesis structure, style of text and writing (i.e., more critical, or more academic); additional data collection or clarified description of collection methods; methodological approaches & descriptions, theoretical framework; research question (requiring fundamental changes to structure of the thesis), etc. The modifications should be made by the candidate within a maximum of six months. Once the modifications are provided, the candidate must resubmit the thesis with a modifications table & letter to the reviewers to facilitate new review. The reviewers perform a new review and have four to six weeks to evaluate the new version of the thesis.*

**** No, **major modifications**: **Major** modifications mean that the thesis is not yet at the required level for doctoral work and significant efforts to align the work with the expected level is required. Such modifications may require substantive changes to, among other: the literature review; thesis structure, style of text and writing (i.e., more critical, or more academic); additional data collection or clarified description of collection methods; methodological approaches & descriptions, theoretical framework; research question (requiring fundamental changes to structure of the thesis), etc. The modifications should be made by the candidate within a maximum of twelve months. Once the modifications are provided, the candidate must resubmit the thesis with a letter to the reviewers. Once the modifications are provided, the candidate must resubmit the thesis with a modifications table & letter to the reviewers to facilitate new review. The reviewers perform a new review and have four to six weeks to evaluate the new version of the thesis.*

If modifications requested, please detail here or on a separate sheet what the Student must address for the Thesis to be of the required standard

...

A copy of this report should be returned to the Programme Coordinator.

Reviewer (signature or name):

Date:

Annexe 5. Joint Report of Viva Voce Thesis Committee



Doctorate in Business Administration (DBA) Programme

JOINT FINAL REPORT OF VIVA VOCE THESIS COMMITTEE

GRENOBLE ECOLE DE MANAGEMENT – DOCTORAL SCHOOL

Name of Student:

Title of Thesis:

Thesis concentration (if applicable):

Date of Viva Voce:

SECTION A - RECOMMENDATIONS *(tick the relevant box to indicate overall recommendation)*

The Thesis Committee recommends

☐
☐

- (a)(i) That the Student be **admitted immediately** to the degree of Doctor of Business Administration.
- (a)(ii) That the Student be admitted to the degree of Doctor of Business Administration **following minor revisions** of the text made to the satisfaction of the designated committee member below, normally within a period of three months of receiving formal notification of the corrections to be made.

Please note in all cases where the Student is required to make corrections or to revise a thesis, it shall be the responsibility of the Viva Voce Thesis Committee to provide details of the corrections and/or revisions required of the thesis. This report with a written statement of the nature of the changes to be made to the thesis will be forwarded to the student and the Student's Supervisor by the Doctoral School administration office.

SECTION B – ASSESSMENT OF THE THESIS

Please give a clear written statement of your opinion regarding your assessment of the subject matter in the box below. This should be a sufficiently detailed statement to justify the specific recommendation made in Section A.

Please comment on the organisation, structure, presentation, authenticity, content, publishable quality, and critical awareness of subject.

1. If modifications required, following member of the Committee will review the revised thesis:

☐
☐
☐

The Chair
The Internal Reviewer
The External Reviewer

2. Please answer the following specific questions, (giving a reason if the answer is no);

1. Does the thesis address CSR-related issues?

YES/NO

2. Does the thesis address issues related to technology or innovation?

YES/NO

3. Does the thesis address issues related to geopolitics?

YES/NO

4. Does the Thesis Committee recommend the thesis for an Outstanding Doctoral Research Awards?

YES/NO

Viva Chair:

Signature

Internal Reviewer:

Signature

External Reviewer:

Signature

Annexe 6. Supervisor Guide

SUPERVISOR GUIDE

DBA Supervision in a Nutshell

November 2026

1- Mission and objectives of The DBA Programme

1.1- Mission

The DBA provision at Grenoble Ecole de Management offers senior managers, independent consultants and academics an opportunity to leverage their careers and/or to make a transition into the highest levels of academia. Students will carry out long-term research projects that are highly relevant to management practice and based on up-to-date scientific knowledge. Their research will make academically recognised intellectual contributions in the fields of technology, innovation and organisational change, thus providing private and public organisations with doctoral dissertations that address their practice and policy needs.

The DBA is a 3-year programme, exceptionally the Student may apply for an extension, the maximum duration is limited to five years.

1.2- Learning goals

Five key learning goals had been identified. By the end of the programme:

Goal 1: The DBA student has acquired the working knowledge in research design and methods necessary to undertake independent scholarly research

Goal 2: The DBA student has acquired a 'state of the art' understanding of theories and practices in his/her area of research

Goal 3: The DBA thesis contributes to practitioner knowledge and/or academic research

Goal 4: The DBA student's work reflects understanding or knowledge of ethical practices in research (collaboration, plagiarism, authorship, data integrity, confidentiality, data privacy)

Goal 5: The DBA Student's work proposes practical solutions to significant organizational or societal issues, and grounds these solutions in current research and theory

1.3- Key Deliverables and DBA requirements

By the end of the programme, DBA students should have submitted a doctoral thesis of maximum 50,000 words (excluding bibliography and appendixes), which:

- Should exhibit substantial evidence of original scholarship and contain material of a publishable standard;
- Should be grounded in rigorous methodology for data collection and analysis;
- Should exhibit substantial evidence of scientific rigor and managerial relevance;
- The content and outlines are quite similar to usual PhDs, including: introduction, literature review and research gaps, research model, empirical study, discussion, conclusion.

Compared to a PhD thesis, contributions must compulsorily emphasise:

- impact for business or society
- impact for the doctoral candidate
- research managerial implications

Theoretical contributions should not be made central.

2- DBA programme organisation and supervisor role

The DBA Programme is a 3-year programme, divided into 2 phases
2.1- Phase 1: Training in Doctoral Research in Management Sciences

Students will participate in a series of research seminars and webinars. They have also to work on the development of their own research project, under the guidance of the supervisor, according to the following milestones.

Deadline	Deliverable	Recipient	Assessment
After 4 months	Research proposal 2,000 words	Supervisor	Agreement from the supervisor
After 8 months	Draft literature review 10,000 words	Supervisor	Agreement from the supervisor
After 15 months	Dissertation Proposal 15,000 words; Defence with one or two reviewers (not the supervisor)	Academic director and supervisor	Assessment by the thesis committee, based on formal feedback from (1) two reviewers and (2) the supervisor

1. The Research Proposal (2,000 words) must include

- **Topic**
- **Knowledge claim**
 - o **Research question:**
One question ending on a question mark
Research question triple motivation
 - o Personal motivation
 - o Professional motivation (why does this question bother practitioners?)
 - o Academic motivation (to what community?)
 - o **Intuition of a possible answer to this question and where this intuition is coming from**
- **Means of answering research question**
 - o Needed empirical material
 - o Empirical material availability and accessibility
 - o Possible methodology for data collection (roughly, as per module in Seminar 1)
- **Expected impact**
 - o How can the thesis be pertinent to the practitioners interested in the question?
 - o How could the thesis be utilised by candidate in his or her work? Or how could the thesis help the candidate's professional development

2. The Literature Review (10,000 words)

The Literature Review provides a critical and structured analysis of scientific knowledge in the pertinent research field. This written document should highlight existing research gaps and must be accompanied by a bibliography (Harvard or APA style). This literature review will be updated

all along the DBA journey, but this first milestone helps the student deepen knowledge in his or her research area. It is the continuity of the first deliverable, i.e., the research proposal. As such, it should cover:

- **Key constructs definitions**
- **State of the art of the literature and addressed community**
What the main streams of thought on the topic are and how they position themselves vis-à-vis each other
On what do researchers agree or disagree in relation to the topic?
- **Gap in the literature: academic motivation for the thesis**
- **What is known and what needs knowing on the topic?**
- **Justified and well-designed theoretical framework (quals) /or hypotheses (quants)**

This written document should highlight existing research gaps and must be accompanied by a bibliography (Harvard or APA style).

3. The Dissertation Proposal (15,000 words) must include

- **Introduction**
 - **Research background**
 - Research questions
 - Structure of the document
- **Personal/professional ties with the topic ±1,000 words**
- **Literature review (±10,000)**
- **Detailed research design with emphasis on data collection instruments and their justification, data collection, evidence of actual access to data, data analysis strategy (±3,500 words)**
letter, emails, confirmation, authorisations, etc. (annex to the dissertation proposal), potential difficulties in setting up research design

NB: No pilot study is required in the dissertation proposal.

2.2- Phase 2: Writing, submitting and defending the DBA Final Thesis

The Final Thesis (maximum 50,000 words excluding bibliography and appendixes) should include

- **Updated Dissertation Proposal ±15,000 words**
- **Methodology ±4,000 words**
- **Main empirical study and results (depends on methods) up to ±15,000 words**
- **Answer to the research question and discussion ±11,000 words**
 - How does the thesis contribute to academic debates? ±3,000 words
 - Impact report: How can society, companies and practitioners benefit from this thesis? ±5,000 words
 - How can this thesis serve the Student's future? ±3,000 words

During this period, the student has to start or continue data collection, data analysis, and thesis writing, **under the guidance of the supervisor.**

3- Supervisor qualifications and training

3.1- Supervisor required qualifications

The DBA supervisor pool is made up of all permanent and affiliate faculty who comply with three criteria. These criteria stipulate that in order to supervise a faculty member must:

- a. Hold a PhD, DBA, HDR or equivalent

- b. Be currently research active (R0-R3)
- c. Have acquired doctoral-level supervision experience in (co-)supervising students engaged in research-based programmes or research projects.

When a young faculty member does not fulfil the third condition, she or he will be appointed as a co-supervisor together with an experienced colleague and be required to attend the training and mentoring programme.

When recruiting a new potential supervisor, the Academic Director should check that she or he meets eligibility criteria.

3.2- Mentoring and Training DBA Supervisors

1. A bi-annual research workshop is open to the whole faculty. Experienced supervisors present and discuss recent supervision activities and guest speakers present their own views and experience in doctoral supervision.
2. Supervisors are invited to play the three volumes of the *SuperWisor*© serious game developed by GEM.
3. Creation and development of supervisory teams.

3.3- Activities for current and new supervisors

1. Current and new supervisors can be invited to participate in EDAMBA supervisor workshops.
2. Current and new supervisors can be invited to participate in the EDBAC conference.
3. Current and new supervisors can be invited to participate in the EFMD Doctoral Programmes conference.

3.4- Issues addressed in the supervisor coaching programme

- Doctoral regulations, admission procedures, resources;
- First meetings between students and supervisors when defining and stabilising the initial research proposal;
- The initial 12-month period during which the final research project is defined and refined;
- Monitoring student progress;
- Reading student materials and providing feedback;
- Problem solving;
- Producing the thesis and evaluating its quality;
- Examination process;
- Final debriefing.

4- DBA Supervisor role

4.1- Supervisor role during Phase I

- Advise the student, specifically on the research question definition, literature review, conceptual and theoretical framework, research design and work plan
- Review written materials received from the student and give written feedback to him or her
- Make him-or-herself available for the student in case of questions or need for interactions (response to emails, face-to-face or virtual meetings, etc.)
- Write a formal review (according to assessment grid delivered by the academic director) of the Dissertation Proposal. This review completes the one that reviewers will write during the seminar 4 defence.

4.2- Supervisor role during Phase II

- Push and advise the student, specifically about research methodology, data collection and analysis
- Review written materials received from the student and give a written feedback to him or her
- Decide whether the student is ready to submit
- Officially ask the academic director to start the review process
- Suggest potential reviewers, according to their academic qualifications and interest in the DBA research topic
- Participate in the DBA viva voce defence.

4.3- Supervision Best practices

- (a) Be very always proactive with the student: define regular meetings (phone, skype, etc.), at least **one working meeting every month**
- (b) In order to avoid sterile discussions, ask the student to **submit written material** before each meeting
- (c) **Keep records** of each meeting (emails, date, content of the discussion, etc.)
- (d) Be at the same time, **very demanding** (rigour and research relevance) and **supportive**. Many DBA students are executives with an important workload
- (e) Remind them regularly of the timeline and key milestones of The DBA Programme
- (f) Should you face any problem (no news from the students, insufficient progress, personal problem, complaint about the programme, etc.), please inform ASAP the academic director

- END OF THE DOCUMENT –

Nos campus en France

► CAMPUS DES ALPES À GRENOBLE

12, rue Pierre Sémard
38000 Grenoble - France
+33 (0)4 76 70 60 60

► CAMPUS GEM LABS À GRENOBLE

142, Av. des Martyrs
38000 Grenoble - France
+33 (0)4 56 80 68 98

► CAMPUS PARIS À PANTIN

183, Av. Jean Lolive
93500 Pantin - France
+33 (0)1 87 03 07 66

► CAMPUS GEM - LES MINIMES À LYON

Pour le Bachelor en Management
14 Rue Roger Radisson
69005 Lyon

Appendix 3 - Withdrawal Form

Director of the Doctoral School
12 rue Pierre Sépard
38000 GRENOBLE

I hereby notify you of my withdrawal from the contract for the provision of the training below:

Doctorate of Business Administration Programme

Session: 01/11/2026 – 31/10/2029

Cohort Choisissez un élément.

Student registration number:

Name:

Address:

Date:

Student's signature:

Appendix 4 - Student's personal data protection

Collection of personal data

The personal data collected is subject to personal data processing for which GEM is controller in accordance with the Applicable Regulations on the Protection of Personal Data. The main purpose of this processing is to enable the Student to benefit from all the services related to his/her course of study.

The categories of personal data collected is as follows:

For the creation of the Student profile:

When registering the Student will be required to provide his/her name, surname, gender, date and place of birth, postal address, e-mail address, telephone number and emergency contact details.

For student social security (French residents only):

With regards to the Student's social security and health insurance coverage, he/she will be required to register their social security number.

For tuition fees payment (French residents only where applicable):

In order to pay the tuition fees, GEM is required to collect personal data from the Student's bank account.

For inclusion in the alumni directory:

In order to include the Student in the school's alumni directory, GEM is required to collect data relating to the position held in the employing company, and, where applicable, in GEM student associations, the Student's postal and electronic contact details and telephone numbers.

Use of personal data

The purpose of the processing of personal data is to enable the Student to take a course by providing lessons and teaching tools, and to use the GEM Information and Communication System in a secure environment:

- Creation and management of the student's academic file;
- Access to and use of the student intranet;
- Organisation of the conditions for monitoring school curricula, including the implementation of assistance;
- Organisation of the conditions of use of tuition payment services;
- Verification, identification and authentication of the data transmitted by the Student;
- Offers of services for the use of educational resources and tools;
- Offers of services to the student in career management;
- Prevention and detection of fraud, malware and security incident management when using the GEM Information and Communication System;
- Organising exams and the issuance of their diploma.

The recipients of the data are the authorised persons of GEM in the following Departments:

- *Direction des Programmes* (Programmes department)
- *Direction de la Pédagogie* (Education department)
- *Direction du Développement et des Relations Entreprises* (Corporate Relations department)
- *Direction Innovations et Expérimentation* (Innovation and testing department)
- *Qualité, Stratégie et Développement International* (Quality, Strategy and International Development)
- *Marque, Digital et Communication* (Marketing, Digital and Communication)
- *Secrétariat Général* (Administration),
- *Direction de la Stratégie Numérique* (Digital Strategy Department)
- *Direction Administrative et Financière* (Administrative and Financial Department)

Sharing with third parties

Personal data may be shared with third parties in the following cases:

- When the Student uses payment services, for the implementation of these services, GEM is in relation with third party banking and financial companies with which it has a contract ;
- When GEM responds to requests from accrediting bodies or the Ministry of National Education in order to ensure the conformity of the diploma sought by the Student;
- When GEM sets up services to put its client companies in contact with the Student to enable them to obtain internships or a work placement;
- When GEM uses service providers to provide services to the Student. These service providers have limited access to the Student's data, solely for the purpose of carrying out these services, and in compliance with the provisions of the applicable regulations on the protection of personal data;
- If required by law, GEM may disclose data to respond to claims made against it and to comply with administrative and judicial proceedings;
- If GEM is involved in a merger, acquisition, asset disposal or receivership, it may be required to sell or share all or part of its assets, including personal data. In this case the Student will be informed before his/her personal data is transferred to a third party.

Transfer of personal data

Due to the school's organization and its international academic partnerships, the Student is informed that GEM is able to transfer his/her personal data to processors or partners outside the European Union. These transfers are part of student exchanges between institutions to enhance student learning. These exchanges are the subject of agreements containing a contractual obligation to use personal data in accordance with the provisions of the Applicable Regulations on the Protection of Personal Data.

Data retention

At the end of the Student's studies, the Student is informed that in order for GEM to meet its obligations as a higher education institution, GEM will retain his/her personal data:

- accessible: 3 years;
- then, filed: 7 years.

A summary of the Student's administrative and educational records may be retained for 50 years from the date of the Student's last activity in the institution.

Security and confidentiality

GEM implements technical and organizational measures in the area of information system security to protect personal data against alteration, destruction and unauthorized access. However, it should be noted that the Internet is not a completely secure environment and GEM cannot guarantee the security of the transmission or storage of data on the Internet.

Enforcement of rights

Pursuant to the Applicable Regulations on the Protection of Personal Data, the Student has the following rights:

- update or delete his/her personal data by logging in to his/her profile and configuring his/her account settings;
- He/She exercise their right of access, to obtain his/her personal data, by consulting his/her school file via the student portal;
- If the personal data stored by GEM is inaccurate, his/her can update the information by logging in to his/her school file via the student portal. Should he/she experience any difficulties, he/she can contact their administrator by e-mail;
- He/She may request that GEM carry out data portability when exchanging data with other institutions;
- He/She can delete their personal data, in accordance with applicable data protection laws, by logging in to his/her school file via the student portal. Should he/she experience any difficulties, He/She can contact his/her administrator by e-mail.

For any request relating to personal data, the Student may contact the Data Protection Officer by post at the following address: Grenoble Ecole de Management, Data Protection Officer, 12 rue Pierre Sépard, 38000 Grenoble or by e-mail at dpo@grenoble-em.com.

If there is no response from GEM, the Student is informed that he/she can directly contact the CNIL (French National Commission for Information Technology and Civil Liberties) at the following address: <https://www.cnil.fr/fr/plaintes>.

Student's signature: